

ENGLISH COURSE BOOK

SEMESTER II

**DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH
D.G. VAISHNAV COLLEGE**

**From the academic year
2024-2025 onwards**

Subject code: 24/AT00202

Credits: 3

No of Instructional hours: 60

English Course offered to the following UG classes:**Shift I**

- I B.Com General
- I B.A. Economics
- I B.Com C.S
- I B.Sc. Mathematics
- I B.Sc. Chemistry
- I B.Sc. Physics
- I B.Sc. Botany

Shift II

- I BBA
- I BBM
- I B.Com General
- I B.Com Accounting & Finance
- I B.Com Marketing Management
- I B.Com Finance & Taxation
- I B.Com Computer Applications
- I B.Com Hons
- I BCA
- I B.Sc. Physics with Computer Applications
- I B.Sc. Data Science
- I B.Sc. Criminology
- I B.A. Economics
- I B.A. Tamil
- I B.A. English
- I B.A. Sociology
- I B.A. Journalism
- I B.Com C.S.
- I B.Sc. Mathematics with Computer Applications
- I B.Sc. Biochemistry
- I B.Sc. Biotechnology
- I B.Sc. Visual Communication (only English)
- I B.Sc. Psychology
- I B.Sc. Computer Science
- I B.Sc. Statistics

PREFACE

The new English Course book has been designed with the intent of grounding our learners in the four fundamental skills of learning English, namely -- Listening, Speaking, Reading and Writing (LSRW). The framework for the English course has been conceptualised, factoring in the challenges in the teaching-learning process, such as heterogeneity, varying levels of competence, socio-economic backgrounds of the learners and the gaps in the formative years of learning English. The book comprises of five units: Units 1 to 3 have nine texts of different genres such as essays, memoirs, short stories, films, features, speeches and vlogs, that have been grouped thematically. The texts chosen are topical and significant and aimed at fostering dialogues and conversations within the English classroom learning space and for our learners to put things in perspective. The Speaking component is also part of the first three units. Unit 4 has Listening, Reading and Writing components with suggested classroom activities to train our learners in the functional use of learning a non-native language. Unit 5 has Grammar and Vocabulary in usage and practice.

English II

Semester II

Unit 1

Travel and Exploration

Lesson	Content	Author	Page no.
1.	Poem Consolation	Billy Collins	6
2.	Book Extract On searching for a once-lost love	Samanth Subramaniam	10
3.	Book Extract Returns	Taran N Khan	16

Unit 2

People and their Stories

Lesson	Content	Author	Page no
4.	Life Writing I am Malala (Prologue)	Malala Yousufzai	24
5.	Book Extract Subramania Bharathi	A.R. Venkatachalapathy	30
6.	Film Pursuit of Happyness	Gabriel Muccino	36

Unit 3

Pandemic and Global Health

Lesson	Content	Author	Page no
7.	Memoir (Extract) A Deadlier Virus Strikes	K.K. Shylaja	41
8.	Feature Unsung Pandemic Heroes	UNICEF	50
9.	Feature India's Comfort Food Tells the Story of its Pandemic	Alia Allana	55

Unit 4

Writing, Reading, Listening and Speaking (LSRW)

Writing	Page no	Reading	Page no	Listening	Page no
Postcard – <i>places and experiences</i>	65	Descriptive passages	78	Conversations	98
Data presentation – <i>brief report based on data</i>	68	Short stories	86	Instructions	103
Profile – <i>life and achievements of remarkable people</i>	74				
Speaking Thematic analysis - <i>Speaking activity based on the prescribed texts</i>					

Unit 5

Grammar and Vocabulary

Content	Page no
Grammar in use	108
Error correction	116
Vocabulary activities based on the texts	Included in Units 1-3

Sample question papers -
120

Unit 1: TRAVEL AND EXPLORATION

1. Poem Consolation - Billy Collins
2. Book Extract On searching for a once-lost love – Samanth Subramanian
3. Book Extract Returns - Taran N Khan

1. Consolation

Billy Collins



Photograph of Billy Collins

Billy Collins

Billy Collins is an American poet, born on March 22, 1941, in New York City. One of the most favourite American poets, he is known for his conversational, witty, and accessible poetry that often blends humor with deeper, introspective moments. Collins served as the U.S. Poet Laureate from 2001 to 2003 and was also New York State Poet Laureate from 2004 to 2006. He was the former Distinguished Professor at Lehman College of the City University of New York. His notable works include "Sailing Alone Around the Room"(2001), "The Art of Drowning" (2003), and "Aimless Love" (2013). Collins' poems often explore the everyday aspects of life, transforming the mundane into something meaningful and profound. His style is praised for its clarity and approachability, making him one of the most popular contemporary poets in the United States. He has won several notable awards, including the Mark Twain Prize for Humor in Poetry in 2005, the Norman Mailer Prize for Poetry in 2016, and membership in the American Academy of Arts and Letters in 2016.

TEXT

How agreeable it is not to be touring Italy this summer,
wandering her cities and ascending her torrid hilltowns.
How much better to cruise these local, familiar streets,
fully grasping the meaning of every roadsign and billboard
and all the sudden hand gestures of my compatriots.

There are no abbeys here, no crumbling frescoes or famous

domes and there is no need to memorize a succession
of kings or tour the dripping corners of a dungeon.
No need to stand around a sarcophagus, see Napoleon's
little bed on Elba, or view the bones of a saint under glass.

How much better to command the simple precinct of home
than be dwarfed by pillar, arch, and basilica.
Why hide my head in phrase books and wrinkled maps?
Why feed scenery into a hungry, one-eyed camera
eager to eat the world one monument at a time?

Instead of slouching in a café ignorant of the word for ice,
I will head down to the coffee shop and the waitress
known as Dot. I will slide into the flow of the morning
paper, all language barriers down,
rivers of idiom running freely, eggs over easy on the way.

And after breakfast, I will not have to find someone
willing to photograph me with my arm around the owner.
I will not puzzle over the bill or record in a journal
what I had to eat and how the sun came in the window.
It is enough to climb back into the car

as if it were the great car of English itself
and sounding my loud vernacular horn, speed off
down a road that will never lead to Rome, not even Bologna.

GLOSSARY

Wandering – roaming

Ascending- climbing higher; upward

Torrid – scorching, hot

Cruise – to travel; to move around or proceed effortlessly

Compatriots- countrymen

Abbeys- monastery

Frescoes- art work done on wall or ceiling

Sarcophagus- ancient burial vessel

Precinct- enclosure bound by the walls of a building; zone

Basilica- an important church or cathedral, esp. one with special designation from the Pope

Slouching-stand, move, or sit in a lazy, drooping way

Vernacular- local or native language.

SUMMARY

The poem “Consolation” captures the poet, Billy Collins’ terrible disappointment at not being able to travel to Italy on a holiday. Cloaked in irony and humour, the poet pretends to be

relieved that he was not vacationing in Italy. His planned trip to Italy, one of the most spectacular and much sought after travel destinations in the world with its distinct historical and cultural heritage, got cancelled due to various reasons, which prompted him to write this poem in response.

To hide his disappointment and to make himself feel better, the poet writes about the challenges he would have to encounter during his stay in Italy. He would have to walk around with maps, guide books and basic Italian books in order to communicate with the local people. He says he is relieved that he does not have to remember all the historical details during his visit to Italy's prominent landmarks, monuments, cathedrals, especially in a city like Rome. He is glad he will not have to ascend uphill as some of the towns are located on steep hills. Adding to the stress, is the task of taking photographs of whatever one sees during a holiday.

He writes that he is very pleased to lounge in the comfort of his own home, enjoying his usual routine of reading the newspaper or walking down to the coffee shop and drive down the familiar streets in his own country which is very relaxing to him. We understand that the poet is consoling himself by making it appear that travelling abroad is not as glamorous as it sounds and that it can be very arduous and complicated. He is also a bit satirical about tourists obsessed with taking photographs. The poet, known for his remarkable humour, makes travel and vacation seem nightmarish and stressful but it is quite obvious to the reader that the poet is actually trying to conceal his disappointment on having lost the chance of seeing the wonders of Italy.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. Which, according to the poet, is the better option - to stay at home or to go on a vacation?
2. List the words/phrases that suggest travelling to Italy can be complicated.
3. How does the poet describe tourists?
4. What are the poet's views on language barriers when one visits a foreign country?
5. The poet finds it stressful to travel to Italy. What are his reasons?
6. What is your opinion on travelling to different places? What lessons do you learn from travel?
7. Pick out words from the poem that define Italy's historical significance.
8. Which are the most popular tourist destinations in Tamilnadu/India?
9. What are the things you would put on your travel checklist if you are travelling abroad?
10. With online translation apps and google maps, do you think travel can still be challenging?

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Make sentences with the following words that suggest some kind of travel:

trek, hike, cruise, tour, fly, drive, transit, ride, traipse, navigate, traverse

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Make sentences with the Italian loan-words in English given below:

ballerina, novel, stanza, concert, cappuccino, trio, marinate, pizza, spaghetti, umbrella

2. On searching for a once-lost love

Samanth Subramanian



Photograph of Samanth Subramanian

Samanth Subramanian

Samanth Subramanian is an Indian writer and journalist based in London, known for his contributions to The Guardian Long Read. He has authored three acclaimed books: *Following Fish* (2010), *This Divided Island* (2014), and *A Dominant Character* (2019). His writing has appeared in prestigious publications like *The New Yorker* and *The New York Times*. Subramanian's book *A Dominant Character* was shortlisted for the Duff Cooper Prize and Tata Literature Live! His book *This Divided Island* won the 2015 Crossword Prize for Non-Fiction, while *Following Fish* won the Shakti Bhatt First Book Prize. He also teaches narrative journalism workshops and mentors young South Asian writers.

TEXT

Mangalore lies on a curve of land that descends from the Western Ghats to the sea, and it is deeply enamoured of its waters—the backwaters of the Netravati and Gurupura rivers, but also the coast, where waves wash up tiredly and rest a while before leaping on their return journey towards Arabia. In his book *In An Antique Land*, Amitav Ghosh describes the ‘great palm-fringed lagoon, lying tranquil under a quicksilver sky,’ joined to the ocean only by a narrow channel of water. Mangalore's glorious stretches of sand were its first ports, inviting boats that could be beached safely. In the Middle Ages, to the Arabian traveller who had never left home before, it must have been an awesome sight: pristine sands, lavish vegetation, a rich entry into a vast new land.

On my way to Panambur Beach, Mahesh, my auto-rickshaw driver, happened to ask me where I was from.

‘Madras,’ I said. (I’ve never quite been able to call the city by its new name, even though it was renamed Chennai just one year after I began living there. I’ve often wondered at that inability. Either it is evidence of a buried conservative streak, or a liberal sense that scoffs at the inadequate rationale behind the change of the name. Or maybe it is simply the very flimsy conceit that a real, dyed-in-the-wool Madrasi would never call his city Chennai, and that I fancy my wool to be as dyed as they come.)

At any rate, I said: ‘Madras.’

‘Ah, Madras,’ Mahesh said, and drove peaceably along for another half kilometre. Then: ‘I’ve been there once, you know.’

By this time, I had been away from home for over two weeks, and I was beginning to miss it. I would have grabbed at any opportunity to talk about Madras.

‘Oh? When was this?’

‘Seven years ago,’ he replied. ‘The strike was beginning just as I got off the train,’ Mahesh said. ‘I had to finally take an auto-rickshaw all the way to my destination, Padi. It cost me Rs 120’. After a minute, delightfully oblivious of all irony, he said: ‘These auto drivers always fleece you.’

Panambur Beach is a dozen kilometres north of Mangalore, just past a giant port that ships out, among other things, iron ore from the Kudremukh mines. A beach festival had concluded the previous day, and all its paraphernalia—ballon-shooting stalls, food stations rusty little carousel rides, banners—still stood, unmanned and desolate in the setting sun, like a graveyard of amusement. To one side was a giant billboard that morbidly advertised the number of swimmers who had died at Panambur each year, thereby cautioning visitors to stay on the sands. It seemed to deter nobody; the beach was filled with swimmers towelling off, or still dripping, or emerging from the surf laughing and playfully flicking water at each other.

Mangalore’s open shoreline has been, in a way, the making of its particularly complex strain of cuisine. Already it is jostled, on either side, by two prominent cooking schools—the Malayali, to its south, and the Konkan to its north. Then there is the food of its indigenous Bunt community and of the newly converted Christians who fled the Goan Inquisition when it began, in 1560, to suspect them of relapsing into their old faiths. Arab traders, settling in Mangalore as well as further down the Malabar Coast, brought their own culinary preferences—what has come to be called Moplah cuisine, with its meat-intensive biryanis and curries.

Which of these distinctive worlds of cooking is responsible for the rawa fry, I am not entirely sure. In all probability, they melded together like genetically superior parents and produced this stunner of a dish. When I was lured away from my search for the perfect fish curry, it was the rawa fry that seduced me—more often than not a ladyfish, or kane, coated with a patina of spice and a sheath of grainy semolina, and then fried into a golden-brown, crunchy segment of heaven.

I ate my first rawa fry at Mesha, an eatery commended highly, in my interrogations of Mangalorean friends, for its food that tasted of home. Appropriately then, Mesha resides in a small, old house near the New Chitra Theatre, so unobtrusive that, in the dark, feeling a little like Theseus in his labyrinth, I wandered down multiple wrong lanes before chancing

accidentally upon the right one. In a string of unlit houses, Mesha's tiny windows were the only ones resplendent with light. In the living room, floored with red oxide and roofed with fat rafters, there were two big tables and a narrow wooden bench that reminded me of school; just beyond was another room with another table and then the kitchen, clearly in my line of sight. I was the only customer there. Mesha's staff had taken strategic positions of lethargy around the living room, all watching a cricket match with Kannada commentary on a diminutive television—a match that was so evidently of the grassroots, sub-junior variety that I was surprised it was even being televised.

The cricket can't have been very gripping, because when I began to ask questions about my food, Mesha's waiters clustered around me to provide helpful, but sometimes contradictory, answers. In a few seconds, they reached a consensus that the chutney accompanying the rawa fry was made of tomato and a little tamarind, but the debate raged longer over how the fish was prepared. One section of the house argued that the layer of spice contained a little egg and flour to bind it to the fish, while the other maintained that there was no egg or flour, and that it was just an ordinary mixture of spices.

Finally, one of the members of the second set disappeared into the kitchen, and in the absence of a quorum, the debate stalled momentarily and eyes started to drift back to the television. Two minutes later, our emissary returned, and in a remarkably bipartisan gesture, admitted that his party was wrong, and that egg and flour were both very much present. The bill was successfully passed. Then a businesslike gentleman, who must have been the chairman of the appropriations committee, cut in to ask if I wanted to order anything else.

I most definitely did. I asked for rice and a curry, which arrived in a shallow saucer, inflammatory with kokum but still somehow smooth with coconut, so deeply ruddy that I was certain it included tomatoes. (I was wrong. I'd learn later that Mangaloreans used tomatoes in chicken and mutton dishes, but rarely when they curried fish.) The parliament around me rattled off the other ingredients: ginger, long green chillies, garlic, onions, and fenugreek. The cut of fish, they admitted, was just of a cheap river fish, to inject the gravy with some sort of flavour. I'm pretty sure they told me exactly what that fish was, but I was too busy eating to pay them my fullest attention.

The fish in the rawa fry was what they called '*murumeen*', a Malayalam word that refers to a type of snapper found in estuaries and seasonally in the lower reaches of rivers. Under its crust of rawa, it was soft and flaky, and hit with citrus from the lemon juice in the spice paste. If I did it right, I could peel off all three layers—the crunchy rawa, the tangy spice, the delicate fish—at the same time, to then assemble them in my mouth in an explosive fusion of textures and tastes. I picked the murumeen clean, spooned the last of the curry into my mouth, and sat back on my schoolroom bench to watch the rest of the cricket match. From outside, as the night deepened, we must have looked like a home-grown version of Edward Hopper's *Nighthawks*, sitting silently in this glowing old house that opened onto the resounding stillness of Mangalore.

GLOSSARY

Enamoured- charmed

Pristine- flawless; clean

Conservative- traditional

Scoffs- to mock or ridicule

Rationale- a logical explanation

Conceit- excessive pride

Fleece- to exploit or overcharge

Paraphernalia- miscellaneous articles needed for a particular activity

Carousel- a rotating platform or ride

Desolate- abandoned or ruined

Morbidly- gloomy

Deter- prevent

Jostled- push or elbow roughly in a crowd

Indigenous – native or original

Relapsing- falling back

Melded- combined

Lured- tempted

Patina – superficial covering or exterior

Sheath- a protective cover

Semolina- coarsely ground durum wheat

Resplendent- attractive and impressive in appearance

Rafters- roof beams

Lethargy-lack of energy

Diminutive- small

Clustered- gathered around

Consensus – collective agreement

Quorum- minimum number of members required to be present at a meeting

Stalled- standstill

Emissary-messenger

Bipartisan – refers to collaboration or agreement between two groups.

Rattled-shaken

Ruddy- reddish

Snapper – a type of fish especially a large marine fish

Estuaries-coastal area (a place where the sea tide meets the river)

SUMMARY

“On Searching for a Once-lost Love” is an extract from Samanth Subramaniam’s travelogue, *Following Fish: Travels around the Indian Coast* (2010); a narrative that follows fish and fishing around the coasts of India. Written in nine chapters, *Following Fish*, is a tale of coastal communities’ relation with fish in India. Subramaniam journeys along the periphery of the peninsula to write these wonderful and captivating stories about fish, fish sellers and catchers in Mumbai, Goa, Tamil Nadu, Hyderabad, West Bengal and Mangalore.

The Indian marine coastline is 8,118 kilometres long and fishing is a major industry providing employment to over 14 million people. The abundant water bodies in India makes it a major supplier of fish in the global market. Hence, fish is the centre of not only food but also of memory, culture, economy, history and society for those living in the coastal regions. There are fish-centered stories in Indian mythology as well.

In this essay, the author describes his travel to Mangalore, on the Konkan Coast, and how he goes to all extent to understand ‘the complex strain of the cuisine’ in the shorelines of Mangalore. The coastal cuisine of Mangalore is marked by cultural cris-crossings - influenced deeply by its geographical neighbours, Kerala in the south and the Konkan coast in the north. Arab traders ‘brought their own culinary preferences’ which was mostly meat-intensive biryanis and curries while the indigenous Bunt community had their own cooking styles and taste. The rest of the essay is about his visit to Mesha, an eatery that had been highly commended by friends, ‘for its food that tasted of home.’

The author goes to every extent to taste the distinct and typical Mangalorean fish-food, and in his quest, he understands that the rawa-fry is a great delicacy thereabouts and abandons his earlier idea of tasting ‘the perfect fish curry’ of this coastal town. His descriptions of Mesha, a small eating place located within an old house, reveals his keen eye and observation of the cultural ethos surrounding the ‘places’ he visits. His detailing of the ‘rawa-fry,’ conveys the inextricable link between food, people and place.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. Where is Mangalore geographically located?
2. How does Amitav Ghosh describe Mangalore?
3. Comment on the author’s connectedness with Madras.
4. What was the significance of Panambur Beach?
5. Why does the author describe Mangalore cuisine as being ‘particularly complex’?
6. What were the author’s reactions on eating the first rawa fry in Mangalore?
7. Discuss the heated discussion held among Mesha’s staff.
8. How would you describe the ambience of the eatery, Mesha?
9. Describe ‘murumeen’.
10. What are your thoughts on travel-writing?

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Make sentences with the following words.

seaside, seashore, shoreline, beach, territorial waters, maritime, off the coast, hinterland, coastline, beachfront

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Match the English names of fish with that of the Tamil names.

S.No.	English names	Tamil names
1.	Mackerel	Naakku
2.	Halibut	Soorai
3.	Cod	Mathi
4.	Anchovy	Panna
5.	Tuna	Kaanakathai/ Ayla
6.	Sardine	Eral
7.	Prawn/Shrimp	Nethili
8.	Crab	Singai eral
9.	Lobster	Vanjiram
10.	King fish	Nandu

3. Returns

Taran N Khan



Photograph of Taran N Khan

Taran N Khan

Taran N Khan is a journalist and writer based in Mumbai. She grew up in Aligarh and was educated in Delhi and London. She has published widely in India and internationally, including in *Guernica*, *Al Jazeera*, *The Caravan* and *Himal Southasian* and has received fellowships from the MacDowell Colony, Jan Michalski Foundation and Swiss Arts Council Pro Helvetica. From 2006 to 2013, Khan spent long periods living and working in Kabul. Her first book, *Shadow City: A Woman Walks Kabul* (2019), won the Tata Literature Live First Book Award for Non-Fiction in 2020 and the Stanford Dolman Travel Book of the Year Award in 2021.

TEXT

In 2006, when I first saw the city, it was in the throes of another transformation. The population had almost doubled to around 3 million, drawn by the promise of peace and economic opportunities. On the slopes of Kabul's mountains, thousands of families built and rebuilt their war-damaged homes, using whatever they could salvage from the ruins. At night the light from these informal settlements lit up the horizon, a city above the city, unauthorized but growing, providing shelter to the majority of the population and becoming more entrenched every day. As far as the eye could see, Kabul was spreading.

Each day, I found a different aspect to this growing city.

On the road to work, I passed large areas that showed evidence of previous town planning, in the strict geometry of the streets. Elsewhere, the growth was more haphazard. I crossed the Silo, a massive granary and bakery built with assistance from the USSR in the 1950s. Its tall yellow walls and chimneys were perforated with holes—relics of the civil war. The area beyond, called Khushal Khan Mina, was laid out over what had been farmland, and was now occupied by multi-storeyed apartment buildings, business centres, institutions and ministries.

The radio and TV station where we worked was at Dehburi, in an area that had witnessed fierce fighting during the civil war. In a photograph I had seen from the time, the streets of the neighbourhood were deserted and the bloated corpse of a soldier floated in a roadside gutter, an ammunition belt still around his waist. The building we occupied had also been damaged during the war. It had later been shut during the Taliban government and was rebuilt in 2003 with foreign assistance.

It was a good place to work, and our colleagues filled our early days in the city with warmth and enthusiasm. Next door was the National Institute of Music, and often our routine would unfold to a muted soundtrack of flutes and drumming drifting across the wall.

I remember early afternoons out with colleagues, walking along the green avenues of Kabul University to see an art show or shoot segments for their programmes. They guided me to nearby restaurants for kebab lunches, helped me pick out the nicest kulcha, or biscuits, from the bakery.

One day a colleague invited me to her home, where her family was preparing for her brother's wedding. We left together after work and I followed her through streets with houses in various stages of repair or destruction. The roads got narrower; the walls came closer. My colleague stopped in front of a wooden door, separated from the road by a small drain flowing with water. It opened into a large courtyard, enclosed by mud walls. In the middle of the patch of brown earth, the family had planted pomegranate saplings. From the window of the bustling living room, I watched her brothers cook samanak, a dessert made of wheatgerm, stirring it in a large pot set on an open fire. The family had returned to Kabul after 2001, having spent years in Pakistan as refugees. This was the first wedding back under their own roof.

And I remember a more fraught walk one afternoon with a male colleague to a house in an informally hillside settlement. Migrant families had built homes in these areas, now as earlier. The simple structures echoed the houses they left behind in the village, bringing the countryside to the city. We walked up the steep slope on a narrow path, bisected by an open drain. Looking up made my head spin. Along the way, we passed children carrying yellow plastic containers of water up the slopes. There was no water supply in these settlements.

To get to the house, my colleagues had guided me along a path marked by small white stones, indicating the area that had been cleared of mines, or unexploded ordnance. This was the legacy of decades of conflict, rendering Kabul one of the most heavily mined cities in the world. A few meters below us, a de-mining crew was at work, sweeping the surface of the earth with their wands. 'Red stones mean danger,' I repeated in my head nervously as I walked on the path that dozens of families took every day. 'White stones mean safety.'

These were my days. My evenings were often spent walking down to the buzzing heart of Shahr-e-Nau market, the commercial hub of modern Kabul. Lights blazed from the many shops that lined its streets, and young men and women walked down dressed fashionably, engaged in the age-old ritual of checking each other out. The street was a mix of the old and new at the time. There were some smaller shops on the ground floors of residential apartments. There were larger department stores like the Chelsea Supermarket, with its slogan exhorting passers-by to 'Be Happy All the Time'. A popular spot with expatriates, its aisles were stashed with expensive imported pasta, cheese and snacks. At the counter, the owner had tacked black-and-white photographs of Kabul from an idyllic past—showing women in skirts and families enjoying picnics. Further ahead was the newly built Kabul City Centre, one of the first shopping malls in towns, its façade covered with glass, its glamour still fresh, its steps swarmed by children hawking packets of chewing gum for a dollar.

Soon we began venturing out further, visiting the homes of friends, exploring bazaars. The choppers flying in formation overhead provided the steady rhythm to which we woke each morning and took walks each evening. Before dinner we walked to the bakery down the street, returning with warm bread tucked between newspapers, crisp and with black seeds sprinkled on top, fragrant enough to speed our steps home. On Fridays we joined the crowd of Kabulis heading to picnics in the mountains near Qargha, a scenic reservoir just outside town. The road would be packed with cars, and each car seemed to be packed with children, large pots filled with food, melons rattling in the boot and mattresses to spread by the riverside.

II

On my first trip, I lived in a house that echoed the spaces of my home in Aligarh. This guesthouse was in Kolola Pushta, a neighbourhood on the edge of Shahr-e-Nau. Until the 1940s it had been an agricultural area dotted with mud forts, where Kabul's middle class built their homes. My guest house too had been carved out from the residence of an affluent family that had moved to Europe sometime during the decades of conflict.

Like in Aligarh, my room in the guest house was in an extension built around an inner courtyard, a space that was cold and barren when I arrived. Behind our compound walls loomed a hill topped by a ruined mud fort. Soon, the colours in the courtyard and on the hill turned to various shades of green, and lavish sprigs of almond and cherry blossoms appeared on the trees outside my window. As the evenings got warmer, I sat out and watched spring illuminate the surroundings.

My days and nights settled into a rhythm of restful languor that seemed both intensely known as well as unexpected. It soon became apparent that the house I returned to during those first few weeks as a bubble of luxury in a stretched city. It was also a place that crackled with rapid arrivals and departures. Sometimes guests came and left too fast for me to even exchange hellos. There were contractors from Uzbekistan overseeing construction projects, Indian engineers working on installing software for different firms, aid workers from Germany and Japan. The speed with which this population flitted in and out of the country was not unusual. Among the first questions I was asked at dinners and work gatherings were: 'When did you arrive?' and 'How long will you stay?'

The city was being rebuilt in part by the kind of people I saw around me. Ironically, they rarely got to experience much of the place they had come to reconstruct. For many of them,

Kabul was simply the blur of streets glimpsed from their moving vehicles. They were told, like me, never to walk.

Midway through our assignment, we decided to find our own quarters and rented the top floor of a nearby house built in the 1970s. We moved in soon after Nauroz, the festival that heralds the Persian new year, and the arrival of spring.

Our landlord was a retired pilot who lived on the ground floor with his family. I had some early run-ins with ‘Ismail Sahab’, as I called him (‘sahab’ being a respectful form of address), especially regarding my ineptitude in the kitchen. But in his house, and through his expansive personality, I got my first glimpse into Kabul as a city with a particular culture and way of life, populated by people who were familiar with its codes and manners.

It was also an initiation into life outside the charmed circles of *khareji*, or foreigners’ residences. At the time, Kabul had power cuts each evening. In the guest house, we could disregard these thanks to the massive generator that was switched on for our benefit. But Ismail Sahab did not own one and refused to invest in one for our sakes. As a compromise, he let us use his electric battery to run one light and our laptops. But even this would be switched off after his own early dinner. As far as he was concerned, we now lived in a house, not a *guest house*. And the distinction was particularly clear each evening: as night fell, one part of the city lived with the darkness while the other powered up generators.

After several evenings spent bathed in the ghostly glow of our computers, we gave up and got our own generator, at a suitably inflated *khareji* rate.

Ismail Sahab was a collector and spent most evenings in a little study that overlooked his garden, a space packed with his artefacts. Some days he invited us over to look at photographs, or his stamp albums. Sometimes he shared the music that he enjoyed: Afghan as well as Indian musicians like sitar virtuoso Ustad Vilayat Khan, or the singer Begum Akhtar. This was the music that I had first heard on the cassettes in Baba’s house. In our own living room stood Ismail Sahab’s gramophone, and over the weeks we worked our way through his collection of classical Indian ragas and jazz.

His greatest passion, however, was his garden. He lavished care and attention on it, arranging flower beds and rocks and water channels according to various theories of landscaping that caught his fancy. It took a closer look to realize that many of the planters were empty rocket shells, or that the bell hanging by the garden door was made of a discarded bullet casing. Ismail Sahab spent most days shifting his chair from spot to spot in his lawn, examining his plants and fruit trees—like a ruler of a small kingdom, with similarly arbitrary whims.

Our standing with him varied like the spring weather. On some days he would grumble about our loud steps and the ‘dancing’ on his roof. Other days he would summon us to dinner, where his wife patiently and smilingly heard out my faltering salutations in Dari (the kind of Persian spoken in Kabul). When I’d introduced myself, she’d realized that my name was a version of one often heard in Kabul. ‘Nastaran,’ she told me firmly, waving away the Indian-inflected version I had offered. ‘You are Nastaran.’ And Nastaran I stayed for her, the tiny white flower so common in Kabul, and which lined the hedges of Ismail Sahab’s garden. I could see them growing from my kitchen window.

We settled in and invited friends over for a housewarming dinner. I have a photograph from that evening. The people in it are mostly young expatriates or Afghans who had grown up abroad working on different projects to rebuild Afghanistan. Everyone is laughing, their faces full of energy and camaraderie. Many left soon after that picture was taken, others a little later. But at that time, it seemed like Kabul was where it was all happening, where everyone wanted to be.

GLOSSARY

In the throes of- in the midst of

Salvage – rescue

Taliban – Islamic fundamentalist group in Afghanistan

Entrenched- deeply rooted

Haphazard – disorganised

Silo - a structure on a farm used to store grain

Perforated- punctured

Relics- remains of the past

Corpse- lifeless body

Fraught – challenging

Exhorting- strong encouragement

Expatriates- foreign residents

Aisle- passage between rows of seats or shelves

Stashed- stored secretly

Façade- front

Hawking- aggressive selling

Languor- fatigue

Flitted – quick movement

Ineptitude- inefficiency

Arbitrary- random

Whims- fancies

Faltering- hesitation

Camaraderie- friendship

SUMMARY

Taran N Khan, in her book, *Shadow City: A Woman Walks Kabul* (2019) brings out the spirit of the people of Kabul, who in the aftermath of 9/11, the American invasion and the fall of the

Taliban rule, attempted to rebuild their lives after years of civil war and unrest. In 2006, when the author visited Kabul for the first time with her husband, on a filmmaking assignment, she could sense a palpable excitement in the air, as people, both locals who were trying to reclaim what was lost and foreigners, who were briefly visiting, tried to help restore normalcy to a shattered land. Taran N Khan lends an authenticity to her commentary by ‘walking’ the streets and lanes of Kabul which gives her a perspective that is firsthand and original.

In “Returns”, the first chapter of the book, she discusses how she returned to the city of Kabul numerous times over the years since 2006 and each time she developed a greater understanding of the city and its people. In the first part of the extract, she describes her various observations of the city that was constantly transforming. She talks about how Afghan colleagues guided her to get the best local foods such as kebabs, kulchas and biscuits. Her visits to the homes of locals, many in ‘stages of repair or destruction’, through narrow lanes and landmines expose the despair and hope of the people of Kabul. The commercial hub of the city with its new shopping malls, fashionably dressed young men and women and its lively vibe and the Friday picnics with scores of families to the mountains near Qargha, not only add a positive note to her experience but also reveal the resilience of the people of Kabul.

In the second part of the book extract, she shares her experience of living in the house of Ismail Sahab which helped her gain an understanding of the local culture from close proximity. Ismail Sahab was a man of many shades. Passionate about gardening, he had an unpredictable temper—sometimes irritated and sometimes friendly and warm. The author enjoyed looking through his collection of stamps and art and listening to his jazz and Indian classical records. The rocket shell planters and bullet casing bells in Ismail Sahab’s garden serve as grim reminders of the violent and volatile past of the country.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. What were Taran N. Khan’s first impressions of Kabul?
2. How did her colleagues help her in choosing food?
3. Narrate the author’s experiences visiting the houses of colleagues.
4. Explain, ‘Red stones mean danger; white stones mean safety’.
5. How did the author spend her evenings in Kabul?
6. Describe the mood in the commercial hub of modern Kabul.
7. What do the people of Kabul do on Fridays?
8. Why did the author buy her own generator?
9. Sketch the character of Ismail Sahab.
10. Kabul as a city in transition. Discuss.

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Pick the appropriate one-word substitute from the text for the following descriptions.

1. lacking any obvious principle of organization
2. a tall tower or pit on a farm used to store grain
3. intense and eager enjoyment, interest, or approval

4. a person who has been forced to leave their country in order to escape war, persecution, or natural disaster
5. the effective centre of an activity, region, or network
6. a disagreement or fight, especially with someone in an official position
7. bestow something in generous or extravagant quantities on
8. the process of making a garden or other piece of land more attractive
9. a party or ceremony celebrating a move to a new home
10. a person who lives outside their native country

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Make a list of twenty-five travel related words and phrases.

S.No.	Words/ phrases
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UNIT 2 : PEOPLE AND THEIR STORIES**4. Life Writing**

I am Malala (Prologue) – Malala Yousufzai

5. Book Extract

Subramania Bharathi – A.R. Venkatachalapathy

6. Film

The Pursuit of Happyness - Gabriel Muccino

4. I am Malala (Prologue) Malala Yousufzai



Photograph of Malala Yousufzai

Malala Yousufzai

Malala Yousafzai is a Pakistani activist who is involved in the cause of girls' education. She is the youngest person to win the Nobel Peace Prize. Malala was born on July 12, 1997, in Mingora, Pakistan. She grew up in the Swat Valley, where the Taliban made it hard for girls to go to school. Her father, a teacher, inspired her to speak out for girls' rights to education. In 2009, Malala wrote a blog for the BBC under a fake name, sharing stories about life under the Taliban and her love for learning. On October 9, 2012, a Taliban gunman shot Malala in the head while she was on a bus going home from school. She survived after getting medical care and became a symbol of standing up against the Taliban. In 2014, at age 17, Malala won the Nobel Peace Prize for fighting for children's rights to education. She later graduated from Oxford University and still works to promote education, human rights, and equality around the world.

TEXT

When I close my eyes, I can see my bedroom. The bed is unmade, my fluffy blanket in a heap, because I've rushed out for school, late for an exam. My school schedule is open on my desk to a page dated 9 October 2012. And my school uniform—my white shalwar and blue kamiz—is on a peg on the wall, waiting for me.

I can hear the neighbourhood kids playing cricket in the alley behind our home. I can hear the hum of the bazaar not far away. And if I listen very closely, I can hear Safina, my friend next door, tapping on the wall we share so she can tell me a secret.

I smell rice cooking as my mother works in the kitchen. I hear my little brothers fighting over the remote—the TV switching between WWE Smack Down and cartoons. Soon I'll hear my father's deep voice as he calls out my nickname. "Jani," he'll say, which is Persian for "dear one." "How was the school running today?" He was asking how things were at the Khushal

School for Girls, which he founded and I attended, but I always took the opportunity to answer the question literally.

“Aba,” I’d joke. “The school is walking, not running!” This was my way of telling him I thought things could be better.

I left that beloved home in Pakistan one morning—planning to dive back under the covers as soon as school let out—and ended up a world away.

Some people say it is too dangerous for me to go back there now. That I’ll never be able to return. And so, from time to time, I go there in my mind.

But now another family lives in that home, another girl sleeps in that bedroom—while I am thousands of miles away. I don’t care much about the other things in my room, but I do worry about the school trophies on my bookcase. I even dream about them sometimes. There’s a runners-up award from the first speaking contest I ever entered. And more than forty-five golden cups and medals for being first in my class in exams, debates, and competitions. To someone else, they might seem mere trinkets made of plastic. To someone else, they may simply look like prizes for good grades. But to me, they are reminders of the life I loved and the girl I was—before I left home that fateful day.

When I open my eyes, I am in my new bedroom. It is in a sturdy brick house in a damp and chilly place called Birmingham, England. Here there is water running from every tap, hot or cold as you like. No need to carry cans of gas from the market to heat the water. Here there are large rooms with shiny wood floors, filled with large furniture and a large, large TV. There is hardly a sound in this calm, leafy suburb. No children laughing and yelling. No women downstairs chopping vegetables and gossiping with my mother. No men smoking cigarettes and debating politics. Sometimes, though, even with these thick walls between us, I can hear someone in my family crying for home. But then my father will burst through the front door, his voice booming.

“Jani!” he’ll say. “How was school today?”

Now there’s no play on words. He’s not asking about the school he runs and I attend. But there’s a note of worry in his voice, as if he fears I won’t be there to reply. Because it was not so long ago that I was nearly killed—simply because I was speaking out about my right to go to school. It was the most ordinary of days. I was fifteen, in grade nine, and I’d stayed up far too late the night before, studying for an exam.

I’d already heard the rooster crow at dawn but had fallen back to sleep. I’d heard the morning call to prayer from the mosque nearby but managed to hide under my quilt. And I’d pretended not to hear my father come to wake me. Then my mother came and gently shook my shoulder. “Wake up, Pisho,” she said, calling me kitten in Pashto, the language of the Pashtun people. “It’s seven thirty and you’re late for school!” I had an exam on Pakistani studies. So I said a quick prayer to God. If it is your will, may I please come in first? I whispered. Oh, and thank you for all my success so far!

I gulped down a bit of fried egg and chapati with my tea. My youngest brother, Atal, was in an especially cheeky mood that morning. He was complaining about all the attention I’d received for speaking out about girls getting the same education as boys, and my father teased him a little at the breakfast table.

“When Malala is prime minister someday, you can be her secretary,” he said.

Atal, the little clown in the family, pretended to be cross. “No!” he cried. “She will be my secretary!”

All this banter nearly made me late, and I raced out the door, my half-eaten breakfast still on the table. I ran down the lane just in time to see the school bus crammed with other girls on their way to school. I jumped in that Tuesday morning and never looked back at my home. The ride to school was quick, just five minutes up the road and along the river. I arrived on time, and exam day passed as it always did. The chaos of Mingora city surrounded us with its honking horns and factory noises while we worked silently, bent over our papers in hushed concentration. By day’s end I was tired but happy; I knew I’d done well on my test. “Let’s stay on for the second trip,” said Moniba, my best friend. “That way we can chat a little longer.” We always liked to stay on for the late pickup.

For days I’d had a strange, gnawing feeling that something bad was going to happen. One night I’d found myself wondering about death. What is being dead really like? I wanted to know. I was alone in my room, so I turned toward Mecca and asked God. “What happens when you die?” I said. “How would it feel?”

If I died, I wanted to be able to tell people what it felt like. “Malala, you silly girl,” I said to myself then, “you’d be dead and you couldn’t tell people what it was like.”

Before I went to bed, I asked God for one more thing. Can I die a little bit and come back, so I can tell people about it?

But the next day had dawned bright and sunny, and so had the next one and the one after that. And now I knew I’d done well on my exam. Whatever cloud had been hanging over my head had begun to clear away. So Moniba and I did what we always did: We had a good gossip. What face cream was she using? Had one of the male teachers gone for a baldness cure? And, now that the first exam was over, how difficult would the next one be?

When our bus was called, we ran down the steps. As usual, Moniba and the other girls covered their heads and faces before we stepped outside the gate and got into the waiting dyna, the white truck that was our Khushal School “bus.” And, as usual, our driver was ready with a magic trick to amuse us. That day, he made a pebble disappear. No matter how hard we tried, we couldn’t figure out his secret. We piled inside, twenty girls and two teachers crammed into the three rows of benches stretching down the length of the dyna. It was hot and sticky, and there were no windows, just a yellowed plastic sheet that flapped against the side as we bounced along Mingora’s crowded rush-hour streets. Haji Baba Road was a jumble of brightly coloured rickshaws, women in flowing robes, men on scooters, honking and zigzagging through the traffic. We passed a shopkeeper butchering chickens. A boy selling ice-cream cones. A billboard for Dr. Humayun’s Hair Transplant Institute. Moniba and I were deep in conversation. I had many friends, but she was the friend of my heart, the one with whom I shared everything. That day, when we were talking about who would get the highest marks this term, one of the other girls started a song, and the rest of us joined in.

Just after we passed the Little Giants snack factory and the bend in the road not more than three minutes from my house, the van slowed to a halt. It was oddly quiet outside. “It’s so calm

today,” I said to Moniba. “Where are all the people?” I don’t remember anything after that, but here’s the story that’s been told to me:

Two young men in white robes stepped in front of our truck.

“Is this the Khushal School bus?” one of them asked.

The driver laughed. The name of the school was painted in black letters on the side.

The other young man jumped onto the tailboard and leaned into the back, where we were all sitting.

“Who is Malala?” he asked.

No one said a word, but a few girls looked in my direction. He raised his arm and pointed at me.

Some of the girls screamed, and I squeezed Moniba’s hand.

Who is Malala? I am Malala, and this is my story

GLOSSARY

Alley – narrow passageway

Trinkets- ornaments

Sturdy- strong

Crammed- overcrowded

Rushed- done hurriedly

SUMMARY

Malala Yousufzai lived with her parents Ziauddin and Tor Pekai and her two younger brothers in Mingora, Swat Valley in Pakistan when Taliban gained control of the region. A young girl with a great thirst for knowledge and a firm belief in the education of women, Malala was angered by Taliban’s embargo on women’s education and freedom. Alongside her father, Malala quickly became a critic of their tactics. “How dare the Taliban take away my basic right to education?” she once said on Pakistani TV. She used various media platforms to amplify the message of women’s education, for which she won awards and accolades. She had to pay a heavy price for her activism as members of the Taliban shot her and she sustained serious head injuries. She was taken to England for treatment from where she made a full recovery and began attending school. Her incredible recovery and return to school resulted in a global outpouring of support for Malala. She went on to win the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014 and has made the rights of women the centrepiece of her social and personal life.

In the “Prologue” to her book, Malala longs for her home in Pakistan since she had to abruptly leave her hometown in the aftermath of the attack which nearly killed her. She and her family resettled in Birmingham but her deep yearning and wistful longing for home is obvious when she describes her home in Pakistan adding all the minute details—her bedroom, her school schedule, her uniform and most importantly her countless school trophies on her bookcase. To her these were the reminders of her life that she loved and the person that she was. Life as she knew it was brutally snatched away from her. On that fateful day, she was returning from school by the school bus with her best friend, Moniba, chatting and gossiping as teenagers would do. As she almost reached her house, two armed Taliban men, stopped the bus, identified her and shot her in the head from close range. This was the moment when her life changed drastically.

After her recovery, in her new life in England, she continues her advocacy for the cause of women’s education through the Malala Foundation.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. Why did Malala have to leave her beloved Pakistani home all of a sudden?
2. Discuss the cultural retrogression imposed by the Taliban in Pakistan.
3. How does she describe her home in Pakistan?
4. How does she compare her life in Pakistan with that of life in the UK?
5. Why did the Taliban attempt to kill Malala?
6. Describe Khushal School in Swat Town.
7. Explain her uncanny knack of knowing something bad was about to happen.
8. Describe the order of events as narrated by Malala on the fateful day she was shot.
9. What are your responses to Malala’s activism and advocacy for girls’ rights?
10. What are your responses to Women’s education and empowerment?

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Match the words related to education with their meanings.

S. No.	Words	Meanings
1.	Literacy	The subjects and materials that are taught in schools.
2.	Curriculum	A statement or theory put forward to be maintained or proved.
3.	Pedagogy	A course or requirement that must be completed before taking another course.
4.	Plagiarism	An official record of a student’s academic performance.
5.	Thesis	An experienced and trusted advisor who guides a student.

6.	Bursary	The art or science of teaching
7.	Transcript	Copying someone else's work and presenting it as your own.
8.	Prerequisite	Ability to read and write
9.	Mentor	A certificate awarded when a student completes a course of study.
10.	Diploma	A financial award to help support a student's education.

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

The following are a few words/terms related to women's rights. Find their meanings.

1. Feminism
2. Discrimination
3. Patriarchy
4. Equal opportunities
5. Glass ceiling
6. Suffrage
7. Empowerment
8. Sisterhood
9. Misogyny
10. Male gaze

5. SUBRAMANIA BHARATHI

A.R. Venkatachalapathy



Photograph of A.R. Venkatachalapathy

A.R. Venkatachalapathy

A. R. Venkatachalapathy is a historian, writer, and translator from India. He is a professor at the Madras Institute of Development Studies in Chennai. He earned his PhD in History from Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi. Venkatachalapathy has taught at several universities, including the University of Chicago and the National University of Singapore, where he held the ICCR Chair in Indian Studies from 2011 to 2012. He has also received fellowships in Paris, Cambridge, and Harvard. He has written many books on the social, cultural, and intellectual history of colonial Tamil Nadu. His research focuses on topics like nationalism, the Dravidian movement, caste politics, and language politics. Venkatachalapathy aims to create important discussions in Tamil social science and has published over 20 books in Tamil that blend scholarship with literary style. Some of his notable English publications include *The Province of the Book* (2012), *Tamil Characters* (2018), and *Who Owns That Song?* (2018). He is also known for collecting and publishing the works of Tamil writer Pudhumaipithan. Venkatachalapathy has received several awards, including the V.K.R.V. Rao Prize in 2007 and the Vilakku Pudumaipithan Award in 2018.

TEXT

IN THE EARLY 1980s the playwright and public intellectual, the recently deceased Gnani Sankaran (1954-2018), plastered Chennai's walls with a poster: in Indian ink on a plain white

background, all it depicted was a twirled moustache and piercing eyes. But even a child could identify it as Subramania Bharati. The poster was a teaser for his newly launched journal, *Theemtharikida*: an onomatopoeic word suggesting apocalyptic fury, drawn from a poem by Bharati.

Bharati is *the* cultural icon of modern Tamil culture. Now, nearly a hundred years after his death, the turban, the piercing gaze, and the twirled moustache are easily recognised by people across the Tamil world. Looking for a nom de plume? Suffix ‘Bharati’ to your name. Want a name for your new journal? You could do no better than pull out a phrase from his poetry. A slogan for a cause? A line from his poems will eminently do. Contemporary writings are replete with allusions to his writings. Tamil writing, nearly a century after his death, continues to flourish in his penumbra.

How did this come to happen?

Subramania Bharati (1882-1921) is exceptional, an abiding influence on modern writing in Tamil.

The poet began his career as a journalist. First as subeditor of Tamil’s only daily then, and later as the editor of a women’s magazine. For his writings as the editor of a nationalist weekly *India*, he had to flee British India. His journals and some of his books were proscribed by a repressive government geared to crush the rising wave of mass nationalism. The first to publish political cartoons in the vernacular, Bharati’s journalistic prose was both informed and incisive. But Bharati was essentially a literary man, a poet – it is hard not to use the cliché, of inspired genius. Tamil has a long literary history with great poetical riches that could way down poetasters. Bharati’s achievement lay in forging an old language steeped in tradition to voice contemporary concerns.

His early poems, written from the barricades at the height of the Swadeshi movement following the partition of Bengal, demonstrated the potential of language for political mobilisation. Bharati was the earliest to write of land and language, and the pain of their subjugation to an alien power. He employed popular tunes from older songs and filled them with new content for a larger, inclusive, democratic public. The songs dealt with patriotic themes: the glory of the motherland and its current fallen state; colonial exploitation; eulogies of nationalist leaders.

Even as he wrote patriotic verse, the grave social inequities— of caste, class and gender — were very much in the forefront of his mind. ‘Without social reform,’ he remarked in one of his early writings, ‘our political reform is a dream, a myth, for social slaves can never really understand political liberty’. *Pudumai pen* (the new women) was his coinage, as are such terms as *puratchi* (revolution) and *poduvudamai* (communism). Bharati’s imprint on the Tamil language is palpable.

Of an all-too brief life of less than thirty-nine years Bharati spent more than ten in exile in Pondicherry, then under French rule.

For someone who declared that ‘Poetry is my occupation’ Bharati’s output was substantial, but not staggering. For all his complains about the poetic muse deserting him often, when in its embrace, his verse was unfailingly superb. Bharati was aware of Whitman and the haiku, and experimented with free verse, thus becoming the founding father of New Poetry in Tamil.

In the high noon of Indian nationalism and Tamil culture efflorescence Bharati's writings were an essential component in the formation of a new Tamil identity. It was in this context, immediately after Independence, that a demand for making his writings public – free of copyright – was made. And for the first time in global literary history the copyright of a writer was taken over by the state and put in the public domain.

Why then is Bharati not celebrated outside Tamilnadu? Why is he not as well-known as Tagore? The Nobel Prize?

As an academic travelling beyond the Tamil land, when faced with the question of how to introduce Bharati, I have often swallowed Tamil pride and described him as the Tamil Tagore. Analogous, but inadequate. To historically sensitive intellectuals my opening gambit has been to say that Bharati was born twenty years after Tagore (a little sleight of hand here; he was born twenty-one years after) and predeceased him by an exact twenty.

Bharati and Tagore are not apples and oranges. They are more like mangoes. But Indian mangoes come in all shapes, sizes, and levels of sweetness. Comparison is difficult and fraught.

But before we attempt a comparison the first question that comes up is: Did the two know each other? Did they ever meet?

Bharati went to Calcutta for the annual Congress session in 1906, a session Tagore had 'ran away from ... tired and disappointed'. In March-April 1919, Tagore travelled extensively in the Tamil country, but the two never met despite being in the same city, Chennai, giving talks at about the same time.

In spite of being a keen follower of Swadeshi politics in Bengal, Bharati came to know of Tagore only after the Nobel. But after the prize he followed Tagore closely, translated many of his essays and stories into Tamil – a compliment that Bharati bestowed on few – and commented extensively on his work and activities. Bharati had nothing but unalloyed admiration for Gurudev. It is therefore a fitting coincidence that Bharati's last published piece was on Tagore's European tour of 1921, appropriately titled 'Sri Ravindra Digvijayam'.

For Bharati, Tagore's greatest achievement was this fame, a fame that redounded to a fallen nation. A fame that he never experienced in his own lifetime. And did not know that he would gain posthumously. Was Tagore aware of Bharati? Despite outliving Bharati by twenty years there is no evidence to suggest so.

A poet who relied on inspiration to write, in volume and variety, Bharati comes nowhere close to Tagore's staggering oeuvre. Bharati faced yet another constraint. Bengali literary history is short, not longer than four centuries in Tagore's days. Tamils can claim an unbroken poetic tradition of two millennia: this can extract a heavy price. Its richness can be a daunting burden, and to make a mark in such a rich field is, to say the least, most challenging. Bharati's greatest achievement was to be the harbinger of modernity in a strongly rooted literary tradition. A century after his death Bharati remains an inspiration.

The question recurs: Why then is Bharati so little known outside Tamilnadu?

Translation into English – its quality or its lack thereof – is the prime culprit. Little was done in Bharati's own lifetime to translate his poems. If about half of his original poetry

remained uncollected or unpublished when he was alive can the lack of translation be bemoaned? When his posthumous stars rose, stray translations made their appearance. After Independence it became a cottage industry. Many translators have tried their hands but Bharati's poetry simply refuses to work in English. Lyrical, reliant on sonic effect, and suffused with a romantic idealism the poems fall flat in translation. M.L. Thangappa's translations work to an extent, thanks to his limited and careful selection. Unfortunately, A.K. Ramanujan attempted to translate only his prose poems. Frost's quip about poetry being what's lost in translation was never more true than in Bharati's case.

The Tagore translation industry is now a century old. Seen as doing little justice to the originals Tagore's own translations have faced much criticism. But at least it won him a Nobel Prize. Over the many decades some of the finest translators have turned their attention to Tagore. The most recent example is *The Essential Tagore*, published by Harvard University Press (2011), the work of Tagore scholars from Bangladesh, West Bengal, and the diaspora.

The other reason for Bharati's oblivion is sociological. The Bengal *bhadralok* produced generations of bilingual scholars at ease in English and Bengali. The English-speaking Tamil middle class forsook Tamil, and has not surprisingly failed Bharati as well. Bankim and Tagore are the staple of modern Bengali intellectual culture. A series of Bengali social scientists have written on Tagore. A quick list would include Amartya Sen, Sabyasachi Bhattacharya, Partha Chatterjee, Ashis Nandy, and Sudipta Kaviraj. These brilliant minds have interpreted Tagore for our times and made him relevant. Historians of such accomplishment as Ramachandra Guha, Sanjay Subramanyam, M.S.S. Pandian, Shiv Visvanathan, Sumathi Ramaswamy, Sunil Amrith, and Srinath Raghavan notwithstanding one cannot think of a halfway decent essay on Bharati.

Bharati is too important to be the monopoly of Tamils. As Bharati's death centenary approaches let us hope that this situation is redressed, and the poet gets his due.

GLOSSARY

Apocalyptic- disastrous

Nom de plume (*French*) – pen name; an assumed name used by a writer

Allusions- indirect references

Penumbra- shadow

Abiding- long lasting

Proscribed-banned

Repressive-to restrict

Incisive-expressing an idea or opinion clearly and in a persuasive manner

Subjugation-the action of bringing someone or something under domination or control

Efflorescence- bloom

Gambit-a clever tactic

Predeceased- died earlier

Fraught-tense

Redounded- strong impact

Oeuvre- life's work

Bhadralok (*Bengali*)- educated class

Forsook- abandoned

SUMMARY

Renowned Tamil historian A.R. Venkatachalapathy's "Subramania Bharathi" is part of his book *Tamil Characters: Personalities, Politics and Culture*, which profiles influential Tamil personalities of the modern times. In this essay, he discusses Subramania Bharathi's works and his enduring influence on Tamil language and culture. Bharathi is so well known in Tamil Nadu that a poster representation of a turban, a twirled moustache and piercing eyes were enough for Tamilians to identify who he was. Bharathi was an integral part of the Indian nationalist movement and routinely protested against the rule of the British and prodded people to awake and claim what was rightfully theirs. He was also a social reformer who passionately wrote about caste, class and gender inequalities. His coinage of words like *pudumai pen* (the new woman) and *puratchi* (revolution) have given meaning to the ideas and experiences of the modern Tamil people and proves that his influence on the Tamil language is quite significant.

The author wonders why Bharathi is not very well-known outside of Tamilnadu and compares him with Tagore who was Bharathi's contemporary. Of the two writers, who were part of the nationalistic movement during the British colonial era, Tagore was definitely more famous. Tagore was the recipient of the Nobel Prize for literature in 1913, which placed him on the global map. Bharathi himself had translated many of Tagore's essays and stories into Tamil. Tagore produced more works and his themes were varied compared to Bharathi. In his short life of thirty-nine years, Bharathi was weighed down by the sheer magnitude of the Tamil poetic tradition of two millennia but he still found his place as a modern literary voice whereas Tagore had to find a foothold in a literary tradition which was only four-centuries old. Lack of quality translations, Bharathi's poetry not working in the English language and the English-speaking Tamil scholars' disinterest in Tamil literature have all contributed to Bharathi's works not getting its due recognition.

The author concludes by reiterating that it is important for Subramania Bharathi to be known far and wide, outside of Tamilnadu, as such is the power of his literary works. He was way ahead of his times, and the world deserves to read his words, even in the twenty-first century.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. Why was Bharathi living in Pondicherry for ten years?
2. What were the themes of Bharathi's poetry?
3. Mention a few of the new words coined by Bharathi and give their meanings.
4. Why did Bharathi rewrite old songs with new content? What were the songs based on?
5. Describe Gnani Sankaran's poster of Bharathi. What was its purpose?
6. Why did the author refer to Bharathi as 'Tamil Tagore'?
7. On what parameters did the author compare Bharathi and Tagore?
8. What are the author's views on translation of literary texts?
9. Explain the line, 'to make a mark in such a rich field is, to say the least, most challenging'.
10. Why is Bharathi relevant in today's world?

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Give the synonyms for the words given below

1. exceptional
2. vernacular
3. barricade
4. subjugation
5. palpable
6. intellectual
7. bestow
8. suffuse
9. quip
10. monopoly

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Given below are words related to literature. Match them with their meanings.

S. No.	Words	Meanings
1.	metaphor	imitation of a particular writer, artist, genre, or art with exaggeration and humour
2.	fable	refers to a person or thing after which something else is named
3.	prologue	the sequence of events that make up a story
4.	parody	short version of a story or tale that has a moral lesson, the characters are usually the animals
5.	epiphany	a direct and vivid comparison between two things usually considered distinct or unrelated
6.	pun	is the moment when a character is suddenly struck with a life-changing, enlightening revelation or realization which changes his or her perspective for the rest of the story.
7.	paradox	principal character in a literary work
8.	plot	a joke based on the interplay of homophones — words with the same pronunciation but different meanings.
9.	eponym	is a logically self-contradictory statement or a statement that runs contrary to one's expectation
10.	protagonist	an opening to the story

6. THE PURSUIT OF HAPPYNESS

Gabriel Muccino



Photograph of Gabriel Muccino



Poster of the film

Gabriel Muccino

Gabriel Muccino is a well-known Italian film director and screenwriter famous for his emotional movies that often look at complicated human relationships. He was born on May 20, 1967, in Rome, Italy, and he loved storytelling and movies from a young age. Muccino started his career in the late 1990s by working in Italian television. He became famous internationally with his films *L'Ultimo Bacio* (The Last Kiss) in 2001 and *Ricordati di me* (Remember Me) in 2003. He later made his Hollywood debut with *The Pursuit of Happyness* (2006), starring Will Smith. His works are characterized by its focus on emotional depth, relationships, and the struggles of everyday life. His films often highlight the complexities of love and family dynamics, earning him a dedicated following and critical praise in both Italian and international cinema.

GLOSSARY

Stock-broker- a professional who buys and sells securities. (stocks, bonds, etc)

Day care- child care centre

Deficit – shortage

Payroll- a list of a company's employees and the amount of money they are to be paid

Good riddance- a problematic situation or period that ends.

Acquaintance- a person who is familiar but not necessarily close

Internship- temporary experience programme to gain practical skills and industrial exposure.

Swivel- turn around and move in a circular path

Motel- convenient hotel on highways

Earnestness- truthful and sincere

Diligence- careful and consistent effort

Gizmo- a small mechanical device

Potential- future possibility

Prospect- opportunity

Underrated- not fully recognized

Notion- initial idea or concept.

SUMMARY

The movie *Pursuit of Happyness*, whose name was borrowed from the text of the Declaration of Independence, narrates the struggle of an African-American man, Chris Gardner as he navigated through the toughest phase of his life. From the title it is evident that Chris Gardner's personal goals are aligned with the American dream. The Oscar-nominated, real-life based movie is one that showcases poverty, homelessness and loss of dignity but at the same time celebrates true human spirit and its resilience. Set in San Francisco in 1981, the movie also foregrounds the issues and challenges faced by the African American people through the story of Chris Gardner. The fact that Gardner is an African-American makes his struggles and hardships even more difficult and complicated, in a white dominated America.

Chris Gardner, whose part was played by Will Smith, sold bone density scanner for a living. He had invested his meagre life savings to buy those machines which were soon becoming outdated. Living with his wife and his five-year-old son, Christopher Jr., life was a great struggle for Gardner as he found it hard to make ends meet. Throughout the movie, he is seen walking the busy commercial districts of the city with the heavy scanner in hand, making it a metaphor for the journey of his life fraught with suffering. A chance meeting with a stock broker would change his life forever. His sincerity, quick thinking abilities and his intelligence, landed him an intern's job in a stockbroking firm. Through the six months of his unpaid internship, even though he learned the job, he suffered many setbacks such as his wife leaving him, becoming homeless, experiencing poverty and caring for his son under the most difficult of circumstances.

After the tumultuous months of internship, Chris Gardner's grit and determination paid off and he finally became a stock broker. Since then, there was no looking back for him. In the final interview scene, Will Smith brilliantly captures the many emotions that Chris Gardner feels at the moment when he is told that he made it. Chris Gardner went on to establish his own brokering firm in 1987 and became very successful. The movie conveys the idea that even if faced with adversity and crushing poverty, the human spirit prevails and triumphs.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. Explain the how the background music of the film aptly captures its mood.
2. Narrate how Chris Gardner lost his last \$5 and how he got it back.
3. Why did he get enamoured by stock brokers?
4. Describe the interview scene.
5. What were the hardships faced by Chris Gardner and his son?
6. What role does race play in the story of Chris Gardner?
7. How did Gardner feel in the presence of the rich and privileged?
8. What were the skills that Gardner possessed that helped him become a stockbroker?
9. Explain the significance of the narrator in the movie.
10. How did Chris Gardner's life change after he became a stockbroker?

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Give the antonyms for the following words

1. deficit
2. acquaintance
3. earnestness
4. dream
5. disappointment
6. constant
7. liberty
8. understated
9. density
10. pursuit

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Here is a passage on stockbroking. Fill in the blanks with the words related to stock and shares given in the box.

orders	stockbroker	portfolio	investment	trading
advisors	discount	financial	commission	exchanges

A stockbroker executes orders or places _____ on behalf of an individual or institution.

Prior to the rise of online _____, it was prohibitively expensive to access the major _____ where market activity occurs. The largest and most commonly known exchanges are the New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) and the Nasdaq. To trade, you must be a member of the exchange.

Alternatively, access to an exchange can be granted via a member firm of the exchange. Member firms and their associates are licensed by the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority, or FINRA, as broker-dealers.

Most stockbrokers work for a brokerage firm. In addition to executing trades, a _____ can also conduct sales activities. They are typically paid a _____, although firms may offer other compensation options. Both full-service and discount brokers are focused on movements in an investment _____, rather than creating the actual investment strategy. A small number of stockbrokers work for _____ banks or specialty brokerage houses that focus on institutional clients and ultra-high-net-worth individuals.

While the titles of stockbroker and financial _____ are often used interchangeably, the latter differentiate themselves by diving deeper into the advisory aspects of a holistic _____ plan.

Another type of stockbroker is a voice broker. These individuals are employed by _____ brokerage firms to provide a measure of customer service. They may be part of a call centre, where they answer general customer inquiries, or provide a concierge service for clients willing to pay for the additional human touch.

UNIT III - PANDEMIC AND GLOBAL HEALTH

7. Memoir (Extract) A Deadlier Virus - K.K. Shailaja
8. Feature Unsung Pandemic Heroes - UNICEF
9. Feature India's Comfort Food Tells the Story of its Pandemic – Alia Allana

7. A DEADLIER VIRUS STRIKES

K.K. Shylaja



Photograph of K.K.Shylaja

K.K. Shylaja

K.K. Shailaja is an Indian politician from Kerala, currently serving as an MLA for the Mattanur constituency and a member of the Communist Party of India (Marxist). Fondly known as 'Shailaja Teacher,' she was previously the Minister for Health, Social Justice, and Women and Child Development from 2016 to 2021. Shailaja gained international recognition for her role in managing the COVID-19 pandemic, earning honours from the United Nations and the CEU Open Society Prize in 2021. She holds a B.Sc. in Chemistry and a Bachelor of Education, and she has written several books on topics related to gender, communism, and public health. Her autobiography *My Life as a Comrade* was published in 2023.

TEXT

The first I heard of COVID was in the newspaper—like everyone else. It must have been the middle of January 2020. Reported first in Wuhan, it was spreading fast through China. We learned that it was caused by a virus of the coronavirus family, which includes strains like Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS) and Middle East Respiratory Syndrome (MERS). The mortality rate was lower than for Nipah but the infectivity rate was extremely high, and the symptoms were very similar to those of other influenza viruses. This new strain was being called the novel coronavirus or SARS-CoV-2 (SARS coronavirus 2). Later, the WHO would name it Corona Virus Disease 2019 or COVID -19.

After the experience with Nipah, every time someone mentioned an infectious disease, my antenna would go up. But in this particular case there was another reason. Kerala had a Wuhan connection. A year before, I'd met some medical student who had applied for an internship with the government. They were students from a medical university in Wuhan. It struck with me because it was a Chinese city, and I hadn't realized till then that there was a contingent of Malayali students over there. When I read about this new disease in the newspaper and remembered our students in Wuhan, I called the health secretary, Rajan Khobragade, immediately. Rajan said we should be worried. Vacation season was starting in Wuhan, and

during their holiday, Malayali students would be coming home to Kerala. What should we do? We were already planning a Nipah mock drill at that time, and we decided to also use it as a dry run for dealing with a new virus.

On 24 January we formed a rapid response team and decided to open a control room in the office of the director of health services, making the DHS the nodal officer for the control room. In the control room we created eighteen expert groups, which looked at various tasks that are part of the larger strategy, such as logistics, quarantine, isolation, contact tracing, etc. Good officers were picked from each district and we gave them specific roles; training started in hospitals all over the state. If the coronavirus arrives on a flight, what should we do? That was the context of our groundwork. At the time many people made fun of us. A viral infection was spreading in Wuhan, a city in China that no one had heard of at that time; most people didn't think it would ever become anyone else's problem. 'Why are you overreacting?' they asked. 'Are you looking for attention? We can deal with it when it comes, stop creating hype'. We heard all sort of things, from criticism to bad suggestion. But we just went ahead and did what we thought we needed to.

By 26 January 2020 the Kerala health department had issued a circular titled 'nCorona Guidelines' which analysed all the information available till then about this new virus and enunciated response procedure. This document covered everything from safety protocols for collecting samples, pre-hospital preparedness, surveillance and contact-tracing guidelines, and standard operating procedures (SOPs) for field surveillance of asymptomatic passengers under home isolation; it even stated the protocol for sending daily health status of passengers under observation. The fact is that we were the first in the country to create a novel coronavirus combat plan, even though we were not sure then if a plan was required.

Even though Kerala is a small state, given the vast number of Malayalis who live abroad, it has four airports. And we had medical teams at each one so that people could voluntarily declare any symptoms. On 27 January, a passenger flight arrived in Kochi. We already knew that some people on that flight were medical students from Wuhan. But once the passengers came outside, the medical teams checked them. And because we did that, we found three symptomatic students. All of them were quarantined and tested for the novel coronavirus.

On 30 January at 7 p.m., I was participating in a programme in Thiruvananthapuram called 'Night Walk'. I was walking at the head of the group when my personal mobile phone began to ring. I had to told my staff to contact me immediately when the result came. The call was from the Thrissur DMO, Dr Reena. 'Madam, the sample has been identified as coronavirus,' she said. I remember that I immediately stopped walking, and the person next to me stopped as well. Even as we had prepared for the worst, I had been hoping the results would turn out to be negative. It was not to be. Kerala had become the first state in India to record a novel coronavirus infection.

After calling Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan to update him and ask his permission to leave for Thrissur immediately, I returned to my residential quarters and told my personal assistant, Pramod P., to arrange travel to Thrissur. By the time we reached Thrissur it was almost 12.15 a.m.; they were ready and waiting. The media, which had got a hint of the situation, was there too. I told them we'd brief them in the morning, but they said they'd wait. There were more than sixty people at that meeting. It was really late but I think it was the adrenaline, from fear and expectation, that kept me going. On the one hand, we'd already dealt successfully with

Nipah, so there was some clarity on how to get going with a response, but at the same time, this virus was highly contagious. In order to create the Nipah protocol we'd looked at the Ebola protocol as a guide. Now, with COVID, we referenced the Nipah protocol, making changes based on what we already understood about the disease. The incubation period for both was almost the same; however, it was believed that Nipah was only transmitted from symptomatic patients, while it was said that COVID spread through asymptomatic carriers as well. This made COVID far more infectious.

The young medical student who tested positive had been admitted to the General Hospital in the city. At the meeting, I asked that she be moved to the Thrissur Medical College, with the area being turned into an isolation ward. I was encouraged to see that everyone in that room was charged up, like firefighters who'd already practised on smaller fires.

It was almost 3 a.m. by the time the meeting got over. The media was waiting outside. We were transparent about what we knew till then. We informed them we'd received the results for one out of the three people tested and it was positive for the novel coronavirus. At the same time, we had a plan prepared to meet the situation. So, the message was simple: 'Not fear but vigilance'. It was of course the headlines the next morning. By 2 February the sample of another one of those three medical students tested positive. This individual was in Alappuzha district. Then, on 3 February, results for the last of the three samples came in, and it was positive as well. That patient was in Kasargod district. I spoke to all three over the phone and told them they shouldn't worry. Since they were medical students, they understood what we were dealing with. There was no treatment protocol at that time, so prevention was really the only route of defence at our disposal. So, to be extra cautious, we decided on a long quarantine. Within two weeks, all three of Kerala's first COVID patients recovered and were discharged from hospital.

For two weeks after that, there were no cases. It was as though the spread had stopped, and we were relieved. But, given the news around the world, we didn't withdraw the team from the airport.

There are Malayalis all over the world, and we knew that if cases were to pop up here it would be through contact with someone who'd travelled. Soon Europe became a hotspot. Since passengers heading to Kerala from Europe usually connect via stops in the Middle East, the only way for us to identify passengers who'd started their journey in Europe was if they identified themselves. So there were announcements on every flight asking passengers to present themselves to the health department help desk.

A mother and son landing in Kochi from Doha identified themselves at the help desk as travelling from Italy. The son had symptoms so both were sent to isolation and tested for the virus. The son would eventually test positive, but the mother didn't. On that same flight there was another family—a father, mother and their son—who'd also started their journey in Italy but they chose not to approach the airport help desk and reveal this information. This family left the airport without revealing their original port of departure, and went home to Ranni, a small town in the central Kerala district of Pathanamthitta.

They didn't think it was very serious. The son in the family was between jobs and they'd come to Kerala just for a meet-and-greet with their extended family before he started his new employment. Not wishing to get caught up in a government-mandated quarantine at a time like

that, they had sneaked off. There were announcements being made all over the state at that point: precautions, warnings and appeals to contact the health department if someone had recently come from abroad. These people, though, chose to ignore these warnings and visited all their relatives, moving around the central districts, Kottayam and Pathanamthitta, and Kollam in the south. Then one day a couple went to the General Hospital in Pathanamthitta with a fever. The hospital staff had been trained to identify and screen cases with symptoms of fever, cold or cough. So the doctor asked this couple a series of questions. Have you travelled outside Kerala? ‘No.’ Did anyone who has been abroad come to your house? ‘Yes,’ they said. ‘Our relatives have just come from Italy.’ This couple was put in quarantine, and they tested positive.

The health department officials immediately went to the house of the people who’d arrived from Italy. When the family saw the department vehicle, they got into a frenzy, arguing vociferously that only one of them had some fever, they weren’t sick, there was no need to go to a hospital. Once they were informed there could be police action taken against them, they agreed to go to the hospital in their own car. They were brought in, isolated and samples were taken, even as they continued to voice objection at the steps being taken. The hospital arranged for counsellors to meet with them and talk, but to no avail. The trio, and later the grandparents—eighty- eight-year-old Joseph and eighty-two-year-old Mariam—all eventually tested positive for COVID.

It now became essential to find every single person they’d come in contact with and test those individuals. But the family wouldn’t cooperate. The Pathanamthitta district collector at the time was a smart young man called P.B. Nooh. When he realized how uncooperative these patients were, he decided to forge ahead without wasting his time asking them. He opened a control room to deal with the situation, and together with the health department and police, they tracked the patients’ cell phone usage, tracing tower locations of all the places they’d been to, marking them on Google Maps, and doing a sweep of each location with an army of field staff. In less than a week, they tracked down nearly 4,000 contacts, which included secondary contacts, and everyone was quarantined. Several tested positive, and the spread had moved to other districts. At the time, this was the largest number of infections in the country.

I realize now that perhaps we were naïve, the way we were seeking to fend off this virus, to prevent it from ransacking the state. We were working on available know-how and were fuelled by hope and the experience of outrunning another infection a year ago. Our team at the health department and the chief minister were certain of one thing: we didn’t want the virus caseload to go up. When we realized COVID was becoming a pandemic, the chief minister called a meeting with the heads of all the government of departments and assigned responsibilities to each department. By this stage COVID had ballooned from a health-related problem into a larger social issue, so it required concerted effort. At the same time, the chief minister took on the responsibility of relaying daily COVID updates to the public.

At the time, we knew every patient by name, every case’s situation and circumstance. One day I was told that a group of seventeen British tourists had disappeared in Idukki. The leader of the group was a man called Bryan, whom the locals referred to as ‘Brayansayyppu’. His friends and he had begun feeling feverish at the hotel, and were asked to give samples. Three out of the group tested positive, but by the time the ambulance reached to take them to isolation

they'd vanished into thin air! It seems they managed to get airline tickets through some middlemen and had left for the airport.

When the police and the health staff reached the airport, they learned the group had already boarded the flight, so they got the airport authorities involved to disembark them. The group was furious, arguing loudly inside the aircraft in front of the rest of the passengers. And given the confusion and fear around the virus, everyone was upset. We asked the chief minister for his opinion, and once he agreed, they were taken off the flight.

The group was admitted to two government institution in Kochi, the Ernakulam Medical College and the General Hospital. Bryan had plenty of comorbidities; he was diabetic and had high blood pressure, so his treatment protocols were complex. Then there was a call from the UK embassy to the Chief Minister's Office, asking after their citizens. Finally, after three weeks of treatment and quarantine, the group was ready to go back to the UK. When they were leaving, they gave an interview to the media about their experience. They said they were grateful they'd been pulled off that flight, and truly believed that their lives were saved because they were in Kerala at that time. They thanked the chief minister and myself for looking after them.

By 11 March there were less than twenty people who were COVID positive in the state, but the Kerala government declared a health emergency. Some weeks later, on 24 March, the national government declared a nationwide lockdown. Monitoring became easy then, because people couldn't go anywhere. Kerala declared an aid package of Rs 20,000 crore to make sure the poor got foodgrains, to take care of the needs of workers from other states, and for COVID care facilities. The state government also set up community kitchens to prepare food for people who couldn't cook for themselves. More than 150,000 migrant labourers, or 'guest workers' as we call them, were stuck here during the national lockdown. We knew that with the loss of daily work most of these people would be in trouble. The government ensured they were given food kits or cooked meals so there was no desperation to leave. The non-communicable diseases control group from the health department made sure people with lifestyle diseases were provided for; medicines for diabetes, high blood pressure, etc., were all delivered home so people didn't go without them.

By then infections began showing up in Tamil Nadu, Delhi and other places. Some of these states reached out to us for our SOPs, since we'd been the first to deal with the crisis. There was no sense of politicization of the crisis then, and we were happy to share our learnings with whoever asked.

On 15 March 2020 we started the 'Break the chain' campaign. Infections were still entering Kerala via people from other places, so following quarantine strictly, isolation and ensuring that no one at home got infected was really up to individuals. The team came up with another simple way to reinforce their message: SMS, or 'Soap/Sanitizer, Mask and Social distance'.

On 3 May 2020 the national lockdown was lifted. By then, because of the strictures that had been in place for weeks before the lockdown, Kerala had made unbelievable progress. Only 499 people in this state were COVID positive when the lockdown lifted. Three people died, but the mortality rate was below 0.4 per cent in Kerala. While many other states were seeing a spike in cases, there was no community spread here. That was the highpoint of our fight against the pandemic.

Our Plan A scenario looked at the possibility of 5,000 cases per day, and how and where those could be treated. Plan B considered a situation in which there were more than 5,000 and up to 25,000 cases a day. And Plan C was a strategy to tackle the possibility of endless cases. In the first situation, we could manage well. Beds had already been set aside at the government medical colleges and district hospitals. The staff were trained to allocate beds such that no hospital in one district would be full at any time. Every single evening, we had briefings.

Kerala is a consumer rather than producer state; a lot of our produce and provisions come from other neighbouring states on trucks. Out-of-state drivers coming in from Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, which were hotspots, arrived at Kerala markets bringing infections. With all that going on, clusters of infections began popping up around such areas, and we were worried. The first wave had begun in Kerala.

Then there was the Onam festival season, in September 2020. At the time, according to projections by the Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, cases in Kerala were expected to surge to 20,000-40,000 per day. But in reality, the spike from the Onam festival wasn't as bad as forecast. There were about 11,000 cases per day at the peak; it was a far cry from the daily caseload of 30,000 we'd prepared for. And we were able to bring it down soon. So, the first wave was flattened very effectively.

Once community transmission began, our focus was to flatten the curve and delay the peak of infection. Those were our clarion slogans back then. And we accomplished that. COVID 19 came to Kerala before anywhere else in the country but our peak occurred after other places had theirs. Ours was a long-drawn-out pandemic. But, because we were able to stave off the peak, we had time to continue to develop and build up the healthcare system.

In April and May 2021, as the country was suffering through the worst wave of COVID and people were dying from lack of medical facilities, Kerala also saw a surge in the number of cases. But we're lucky we did not face the levels of heartbreak many parts of the country faced back then. There was no desperation here because we had already allocated resources anticipating such a situation, and since we'd planned for it, we were able to go through that horrific summer without suffering as much devastation. The average mortality rate in the state remained around 0.5 per cent at that time.

In late 2020, the central government had announced two vaccines. Right away, we created a public campaign encouraging people to take either of them, and we prepared the healthcare system to start the distribution.

As the health minister (May 2016-2021), I oversaw the early phase of Kerala's COVID challenge. My responsibility was to create a solid foundation that would help our state cope if the infection became a crisis. I believe we did that. When I weigh our entire set of decisions and moves, I think the most important thing we did was also the simplest: the Kerala government took COVID seriously. We didn't wait for anyone to tell us it was a grave situation; we didn't look around for affirmation or listen to the critics. Taking this infection seriously even before it was a problem became our early-mover advantage.

In Kerala the healthcare system has prevailed throughout, never crumbling as waves of infections came and went. The investment of time and energy in equipment and training, the disaster management planning: this is what helped a government save its people from

needlessly dying. Looking back, I believe we did the best job we possibly could, and we laid the foundation for strengthening the system for another generation.

GLOSSARY

Mortality- death rate

Enunciated- speak clearly

Surveillance- close observation, especially of a suspected spy or criminal

Adrenaline -a hormone produced by the body when a person is frightened, angry, or excited

Contagious- a disease than can spread rapidly

Incubation- growth and development

Vociferously – loud.

Fend off- to defend oneself against something or someone.

Ransacking- destructive

Disembark- unload

Comorbidities- multiple health conditions.

Reinforce- to make something stronger

Stave off- temporary delay

Surge- sudden increase

Affirmation- validation.

SUMMARY

The unprecedented Covid-19 global pandemic turned the world upside down bringing things to a standstill. Looking back, it is heartwarming to note some of the outstanding contributions made by several individuals across the globe in handling this huge crisis. One among them is Ms. K.K. Shylaja, former Health Minister of Kerala, who turned out to be a brilliant crisis manager in combating the virus and earning the sobriquet, ‘Slayer of Corona,’ by *The Guardian*. Like many global women leaders who displayed efficient skills in handling the Covid pandemic, she too led the state of Kerala in effectively managing the Nipah outbreak in 2018 and later Covid in 2020-21 for which she was honoured by the United Nations. *The Financial Times* named her as one of the 12 most influential women of 2020.

In the chapter titled, “A Deadlier Virus Strikes” from her book, *My Life as a Comrade*, she narrates her experience handling the Covid crisis as the former health minister of Kerala. As a science teacher, scientific thinking always remained an integral part of her decision making evidenced in the way she not only foresaw the inevitable arrival of Covid-19, when it was still a China story, in January 2020 but was also able to fully grasp the implications. By January 2020 itself, Kerala was well prepared with a set of guidelines, standard operating procedures,

18 rapid response teams, a control room and had deployed medical officers at the state's four airports for checking people with corona virus symptoms. The three medical students who returned from Wuhan were the first reported Covid cases in India. The strict protocols in place ensured that they fully recovered. K.K.Shailaja also recounts how her team carefully monitored people who returned from hotspots in Europe and still a family of three managed to slip and mingle with the general population. This family later would test positive and became superspreaders who infected numerous people in their circles. Without judgement, the health minister's team provided treatment to the family members. When a group of British tourists who were symptomatic, boarded a flight back to the UK, they were made to disembark against their wishes. Later, they were treated in Kerala, recovered from Covid and returned home. The state also provided food and stay for the 'guest workers' as the migrant workers are referred to, which made life easier and less burdensome for them.

In a state with high population density, a large elderly population and people with comorbidities, the task was challenging and difficult for her. But what made the situation in Kerala different was the state was guarded and all set to contain the virus when it arrived in January 2020. The strategies - trace, quarantine, test, isolate and treat, helped in fighting the deadly virus at that time. At the end of it, yes, there were surges in the number of cases but it was all manageable and under control as the system never crumbled under pressure and the mortality rate was very low.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. When Ms. K.K.Shailaja along with her team prepped up for Corona virus in January 2020, many people made fun of them. What was the reason?
2. What are the similarities/dissimilarities between Nipah and Covid-19?
3. Describe the steps taken by the Kerala Government to feed migrant workers/guest workers from the other states during lockdown.
4. Kerala is a consumer state rather than a producer state. In what way did this impact Kerala during the lockdown?
5. "Kerala had a Wuhan connection." Give details of the connection.
6. How did the Health Minister foresee that the first corona cases may be reported in Kerala in January 2020?
7. Narrate the incident of the British tourists in Kerala.
8. Discuss the District Collector P B Nooh's clever strategies in the Pathanamthitta district.
9. Trace the circumstances that required a 'concerted' effort on the part of the Kerala government to combat Covid.
10. Summarize the steps taken by the Health Minister to flatten the corona virus in Kerala.

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Give the meanings of the following words related to the pandemic.

1. Virology
2. Epidemiology
3. Pulmonology
4. Pharmacology
5. Hematology
6. Histopathology
7. Mycology
8. Pathology
9. Physiology
10. Radiology

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Give the antonyms for the following words.

1. morality
 2. enunciate
 3. affirm
 4. ransack
 5. surge
 6. vociferous
 7. contagious
 8. incubate
 9. defend
 10. embark
-

8. UNSUNG PANDEMIC HEROES

UNICEF



UNICEF

UNICEF, established on December 11, 1946, by the UN General Assembly, was originally named the United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund. Its headquarters is in New York City, and it operates in 192 countries and territories. The organization focuses on several key areas, including child survival and development, basic education and gender equality, protection from violence and exploitation, addressing HIV/AIDS in children, and advocating for children's rights. Funded entirely by voluntary contributions from governments and private donors, it has a significant global impact, contributing to children's welfare. UNICEF has received numerous awards, including the Nobel Peace Prize in 1965.

TEXT

Extraordinary people are going above and beyond to serve their communities.

For some it's a sense of duty. For others it's an obligation. And then there are those for which it's a necessity.

Two years ago, the World Health Organization declared the coronavirus outbreak a global pandemic. Nobody knew exactly what lay ahead. But over the course of the following 24 months, extraordinary women and men have risen to the occasion to serve their communities.

Their names aren't necessarily recognizable. But the actions of these heroes have without a shadow of a doubt made our world a safer, better place. We want to introduce you to just a few of these incredible people.

A Ugandan healthcare worker uses a megaphone to encourage her community to get vaccinated

When Judith Candiru was growing up, she always admired the white outfits nurses wore. For her, it was emblematic of the care they provided. Now she's one of them. She takes pride in putting on that sharp uniform, complete with a yellow belt.

COVID-19 has been personal for Candiru. She contracted the virus at one point and recalls the stigma she and her family endured at the time.

"This was the saddest moment of my career. I and my family were shunned by the community."

It didn't stop her though. She recovered and bounced back to work. Candiru passionately serves the people of Yumbe District in northern Uganda, which straddles the border with South Sudan.

In the morning, she heads to the maternity ward where she cares for premature babies. Through UNICEF-supported training, she's able to support sick infants and ensure they thrive.

But that's just part of her day. Throughout the pandemic, after consultations and finishing her rounds on the ward, she'll head out into the local community either on a motorbike or on foot.

Equipped with a megaphone, Candiru has been amplifying the message that COVID-19 vaccines are safe and important. Her message has resonated. Members of the community trust her, and that's evident as one by one they sit on a bench and receive their shots from Candiru.

Climbing mountains and crossing canyons in Nepal with vaccines on her back

Birma Kunwar has been weaving her way up mountains and across suspended footbridges for years now. With a box of vaccines perched on her back, she ascends hilly pathways in the remote part of Nepal's far west.

Even before the COVID-19 pandemic, Kunwar would collect lifesaving vaccines in the town of Khalanga, which is the district headquarters of the Darchula District. Those doses were mainly for the routine immunization of children that lived in the villages that nest on the hillside she climbs.

The pandemic brought a new challenge and a new opportunity: "I've been walking the same path but with these new vaccines," she says. People are eagerly waiting for vaccines, they ask me constantly when they will arrive, when they can get it, when it will be their turn. All the time."

Her destination on this journey is a health post in the village of Duhun. And at some times of the year, it can only be reached on foot.

"The roads here are unreliable for many months of the year, particularly during the monsoon," Kunwar notes as she explains the dangers posed by landslides. "It's a risky ride."

So with the weight of a community's health on her back, she often walks the entire stretch. That takes between three to four hours. For Kunwar, that journey is well worth it. Delivering essential vaccines to these communities is not only a job for her, it's a duty.

The teenage innovator whose invention is making handwashing safer

Emmanuel Cosmos Msoka is an innovator and an activist. It's no coincidence that the 18-year-old from Tanzania invented a crucial hygiene tool during the pandemic that has a water theme to it.

"I was born at the foot of Africa's highest peak, Mount Kilimanjaro," he says. The only place in my country where water turns to snow and ice."

Emmanuel grew up with a desire to change the way things are normally done and to help solve social problems. That's what he's achieved. When COVID-19 arrived in Tanzania and his community struggled to combat the disease, he stepped up.

His idea: a handwashing machine that uses foot pedals to function, in turn reducing the chance of spreading the virus. Since developing the technology, he's been able to supply over 400 handwashing stations across northern Tanzania.

For his work, Emmanuel was appointed as a UNICEF Youth Advocate and nominated for the International Children's Peace Prize, awarded annually to a child who has made a significant contribution to advocating for children's rights.

Caring for her siblings while studying in times of loss

Keysha is 14 years old. But her wisdom and thoughtfulness go beyond her years, as she's had to grow up fast. Her mother, who worked at a restaurant, lost her life to COVID-19.

"Our mother worked 12-hour days when the restaurant opened for business again," Keysha says. "Her immune system was weak, that's probably why she got COVID."

Keysha has had to take on more responsibility, caring for her two younger siblings. She's been looking after her 7-year-old sister Afifa whose been particularly affected. After school, Afifa will often retreat to her room and spend hours watching family videos with her mother's voice.

In addition to her caregiving role, Keysha is aware of her father's financial struggles as the family's sole breadwinner. He works as a parking attendant at the restaurant where his late wife also worked. So, to help out, Keysha is planning to enrol in a vocational school that will enable her to get a job faster and support her father.

Along with her siblings, Keysha is among tens of thousands of children that have lost a parent or caregiver due to COVID-19 in Indonesia. They're being assisted by UNICEF's mental health and psychosocial support programme, with the help of local governments. .

GLOSSARY

Obligation- responsibility

Shunned-rejected

Straddles-connection

Thrive – prosper

Resonated- to appeal to someone in an emotional way

Perched-balanced

SUMMARY

The Covid-19 pandemic that swept the world in 2020 changed so many things for people. Fear of death, suffering, loss of livelihood, death of loved ones, shortage of healthcare facilities, desperation, loneliness and disillusionment were what people all over the world faced. In the midst of such a catastrophic event, most people wanted to protect themselves from the disease except doctors, healthcare staff, providers of essential services and goods who put their lives at risk so that they could help others. They were the real heroes of the pandemic. This short essay, however, profiles four individuals from far flung places of the world who rose to the

occasion during the pandemic and helped the community and others in so many ways. The UNICEF honoured them on their webpage and called them the ‘unsung pandemic heroes’.

Judith Candiru was a neo-natal nurse in the Yumbe District of Northern Uganda and her life’s mission was to help others. On her typical day, after her work at the hospital, she would go to the local community on motorbike or by foot equipped with a megaphone, she would spread the message of the importance of vaccination. People trusted her and came forward to take the shot from her. Birma Kunwar of Nepal was all too familiar with the mountainous terrains of her country. She was a social worker who used to take immunisation vaccines for children in a box carried on her back. During the pandemic, she carried Covid vaccines through the difficult paths so that the community can be safe.

A nominee for the International Children’s Peace Prize, Emmanuel Cosmos Msoka from Tanzania always wanted to solve social problems. When Covid hit, he came up with an ingenious handwashing machine that uses foot pedals to operate in order to reduce contact and spreading. He was able to deliver over 400 handwashing stations in Northern Tanzania which would have contributed to reducing the spread of the disease. In Indonesia, as in many other countries, thousands of children lost at least one parent or caregiver because of Covid. Keysha, a fourteen-year-old girl was one them. Her mother, who worked at a restaurant, died due to Covid and she stepped in to care for her two younger siblings including a seven-year-old. Her father worked long hours as a parking attendant to provide for the family and Keysha had to take on the added responsibility to care and nurture her siblings.

These four individuals from the diverse regions of the world were extraordinary people, who, in the face of challenges, drew strength from within and helped others and the community at large. There may be numerous such stories of everyday heroes during the pandemic that the world has not heard of and it is important to acknowledge their contributions towards making the world a better place.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHENSION

1. How did Covid change the world?
2. What was Judith Candiru’s dream when she was growing up?
3. How did she contribute to her community’s welfare during Covid?
4. Describe the route taken by Birma Kunwar during her vaccine rounds.
5. How did the pandemic bring a ‘new challenge’ for Birma Kunwar?
6. What did Emmanuel Cosmos Msoka invent?
7. How was Emmanuel rewarded for his exemplary work during Covid?
8. Why did Keysha had to grow up fast?
9. How did her father provide for the family?
10. Narrate your personal experiences during the Covid-19 pandemic.

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Choose the correct answer from the options given below and fill in the blanks.

perched	resonate	extraordinary	enrolled	advocate
emblematic	retreated	incredible	endured	combat

1. Some animals have _____ abilities to fly.
2. It's _____ to me that such a lazy person could be so successful.
3. Dogs are _____ of faithfulness.
4. We _____ the lecture for as long as we could.
5. His contributions to medicine and particularly hand surgery continue to _____ today.
6. The cat was _____ on top of the pole and was too afraid to come down.
7. It helps _____ heart disease and can extend your life by up to six years.
8. He was a strong _____ of free market policies and a multi-party system.
9. They _____ behind trees for safety.
10. They _____ several volunteers for the awareness campaign.

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 2

Give the meanings for the following words and terms related to the pandemic

1. isolation
2. quarantine
3. transmission
4. asymptomatic
5. incubation period
6. social distance
7. PPE
8. lockdown
9. contact tracing
10. sanitise

9. INDIA'S COMFORT FOOD TELLS THE STORY OF ITS PANDEMIC

Alia Allana



Photograph of Alia Allana

Alia Allana

Alia Allana is a journalist who contributes regularly to *The New York Times*, *The Fountain Ink*, *The Atlantic*, *Gulf News*, *The Hindu*, *Indian Express* and *The Print* on issues of national and global significance. She studied International Relations at the London School of Economics. She started her career at The Indian Express, where she reported on the 26/11 attacks among many other important events. Allana has covered major events like the Arab Spring, the Syrian conflict, and the rise of ISIS. She has won several journalism awards for her work on crime, business, women's issues and human rights.

TEXT

The evening, Surender Malik recalls, was a blur. It was March 24, and the coronavirus outbreak had been declared a pandemic about two weeks prior. Thus far India appeared not to have been badly affected, at least if official figures were anything to go by. The authorities were implementing ever-stricter rules, and parts of New Delhi were beginning to thin out, but Malik was still able to go to work at the biscuit factory he ran just outside the capital.

That would soon change as a lockdown was announced for three weeks, with four hours' notice. Moments after, both of Malik's cell phones began vibrating—workers heading in for the night shift, and their supervisor, were panicking. "Most had never heard of a lockdown before," he told me.

Malik slipped on his office shoes and sped back to work, a short drive away. Once there, he checked his inventory and, assured that he had enough supplies for a week's worth of output, began leading teams of workers in making as many biscuits as they could before the lockdown came into force. The brand he produces, Parle-G, is ubiquitous across India, and the process is

tightly scripted: wheat flour, sugar, milk powder, salt, palm oil, preservatives, and flavouring are all added at specific points over a 20-minute period. The biscuits are baked for precisely eight minutes at up to 536 degrees Fahrenheit. Malik and his colleagues frantically churned out batch after batch. By midnight, when he had to shut down the gas valves powering the ovens, turn down the air pressure, and seal bags of raw materials, he and his colleagues had made 25 tons of biscuits.

By then, however, the restrictions were in force. As a result, no trucks could transport any of the biscuits, nor bring in additional supplies; retailers, distributors, and warehouses couldn't store them; and neither Malik nor any of his team were supposed to be on the premises. So Malik appointed a maintenance worker, an electrician, and a janitor to stay at the factory while the other workers on-site filed out. For only the second time in the 90-year history of Parle Products, its facilities were closing—the only other such instance was during the partition of India and Pakistan.

Like many other Indians, Malik had less than four hours to make transformative decisions, ones that would have ramifications for himself, his family, his colleagues, and his employer, all without a road map. Yet his were more impactful than most: The product he makes is among the most universally consumed in India.

Across the country's varied culinary landscape—where what one eats can signal class, caste, religion, ethnicity, and income—Parle-G biscuits are neutral. Wealthier Indians dip them in milky tea, poorer ones in water. A pack sells for as little as 2 Indian rupees, or about 3 cents, and can be found at five-star hotels as well as in the fields of rural India. They are a symbol, as the sociologist Amita Baviskar puts it, of consumer citizenship, of an aspirational equality.

Over time, as the coronavirus outbreak has worsened in India, the government has variously extended and eased its lockdown, but these past two months have not been experienced uniformly. The rich and middle class retreated into their gated communities with stocked pantries while a migrant exodus unfolded, with casual labourers trekking, often by foot, for days at a time back to their home villages. Here again, we see the Parle-G biscuit's universality: In richer neighbourhoods of Mumbai, Delhi, and elsewhere, stores were sold out of it, whereas for many working-class citizens, a glucose biscuit was an easily digestible antidote to hunger as they headed home. Reports and social-media videos have narrated stories nationwide of desperate workers fighting off hunger by unwrapping Parle-G's iconic wax-paper packaging for some sustenance. Near Delhi, a group of workers undertaking the several-hundred-mile journey home on bicycles spoke of surviving on Parle-G biscuits and water. In Agra, the home of the Taj Mahal, doctors threw packets of Parle-G at those being held at a university-turned-quarantine facility.

Malik told me about how he had seen impoverished workers at construction sites and porters at railway stations eat them. "We have to ensure the supply does not stop," he said. "It is a social responsibility."

Parle-g biscuits are India's comfort food. In 1929, Mohanlal Dayal Chauhan, an Indian businessman, established Parle Products, naming it after the Mumbai suburb, Vile Parle, where it was founded. For Chauhan, the company was his contribution to a broader nationalist push toward self-reliance and resistance to British colonial imports. He produced, priced, and packaged the biscuits for both India's poor and its wealthy, and they became an instant success.

Parle-G biscuits were India's first truly popular branded food item. Today, the company says they are the world's best-selling biscuit by volume, with more than a billion packets made every month.

As Parle Products has grown, and India has changed, the Parle-G biscuit itself has remained, in essence, unchanged, available at the smallest corner shop and the swankiest supermarket. In foreign lands, a Parle-G dunked in tea offers a taste of the familiar. From my days as a university student in London to my travels backpacking across Asia and West Africa, Parle-G biscuits—targeted at the Indian diaspora—transformed from a childhood passion to a memory of home.

The lockdown affected all 135 Parle-G factories across India. With more than 10,000 employees on the rolls and about 50,000 more working indirectly for the company, according to Parle Products—as well as many informal workers—an intricate system unravelled. The government had allowed the production and sale of essential commodities but did not clearly spell out what was “essential,” with implementation and interpretation varying across the country. Parle executives met with federal and state government officials, who eventually clarified that biscuits were considered essential.

Malik returned to the factory on March 30, less than a week after Modi's announcement. He and his colleagues wore masks, underwent thermal scanning, sanitized their hands, and walked through a tray of bleach solution into the factory. There was no question that he would lead them in: Malik is close to many of his colleagues, calling the younger ones “my boys.” He has kept in regular touch with those who have set off to faraway homes, fearful for them, as many migrant workers have died en route. The son of the headmaster of a nearby government-funded school, Malik was the first member of his family to enter the corporate world. The year he joined Parle, 1991, was a seminal one for India, with the government dismantling a socialist economy and setting the country on a path of stunning economic liberalization. Over the course of his career, he moved across different factories nationwide, was able to buy a house, and could take his wife on a 25th-wedding-anniversary holiday to Singapore and Malaysia. When others spoke of his journey—from commuting to work on crowded trains, then upgrading to a personal scooter, and, eventually, buying his own car with a parking spot on the factory premises—they recounted a tale of aspiration similar to the one often told about his country.

Still, not all his colleagues joined him; about a tenth of the factory's workers were migrants, and many had returned to their home villages. Others just didn't come in, either because a lack of public transport meant they couldn't make it to work, their local area forbade them from leaving, or they feared the coronavirus. The lower numbers of staff translated to reduced output: Malik and his team were only able to produce 20 tons a day once they returned to work.

The restrictions affected India's supply chain at every step along the way. When the first truck carrying Parle-G after the lockdown was put in place reached Navin Shantilal Dhedia, a wealthy distributor in East Mumbai, he clambered on board and started off-loading them himself—his staff couldn't make it to work. Salesmen like Ankit Dhuriya, the link between distributors like Dhedia and individual stores, declined to report in, as the journey meant navigating coronavirus hotspots. Store owners were forced to pick up stock directly from storage depots. Dhedia's sales fell by two-thirds. India has 12 million small retail stores, which together employ some 40 million people and generate more than \$9 billion in annual revenue. Unable to maintain supplies of Parle-G and other products, many had to temporarily close.

Three days after the lockdown was implemented, Ram Prajapati, a construction worker in Gurgaon, a major commercial centre of shimmering office blocks, extravagant malls, and opulent apartment towers near New Delhi, ran out of food. The contractor who hired him and other workers wouldn't answer his calls. He and his wife had 100 rupees, or a little more than \$1, left. They bought flour, tomatoes, and two packets of 2-rupee Parle-G biscuits for their 3- and 7-year-old sons. As crowds of out-of-work people lined up at community kitchens for food handouts, Prajapati was reluctant to join them. "I came to the city to work," he told me, "not to beg."

As it became clear that work would not resume for a while, Prajapati decided to walk with his family back to his village, 600 miles away. They set off with a small plastic bag full of essentials, Prajapati carrying his 3-year-old on his shoulders. At one point in the journey, the older boy was exhausted and unable to walk farther, so his mother offered him a Parle-G. The glucose biscuits were easy to carry, offered a quick source of energy, and had a level of standardization, meaning they could be trusted. Three days later, through a combination of walking and hitching rides with essential-goods trucks, the Prajapatis reached home, having survived largely on food from volunteers along the way, as well as Parle-G biscuits.

More than two months after it was announced, India's lockdown is beginning to ease in parts, and companies are seeking to ramp up production, yet many still face shortages of labour. The country and its businesses need informal and migrant workers to return, but there is little incentive for them to, with no change thus far to their pay and benefits.

At Malik's Bahadurgarh factory, worker attendance hovers at about 80 percent, but the facility recently had to shut down when certain key staff couldn't make it to work. Elsewhere in India, sites have struggled because they are in containment zones. Mayank Shah, the head of marketing for Parle Products' biscuits, told me the company "never imagined a scarcity of labour," and was now looking at increasing automation and offering training for its workers "so that they move away from menial jobs."

When I spoke to Malik recently, he recounted how years ago, he and his wife would try to coax their children, now in their 20s, to drink milk by bribing them with biscuits; how, more recently, he had seen photos on his phone of migrant labourers eating the biscuits with water; how he had read reports of the biscuits being sold at inflated prices at worker encampments.

The varied experiences made me think of how the Parle-G—India's ubiquitous biscuit, its comfort food, its egalitarian snack—was not just made for all manner of Indians. It was made by them, too.

GLOSSARY

Blur-dim

Inventory-stock

Ubiquitous-omnipresent or common

Frantically-urgent

Churned-intensity

Janitor-someone who cleans and maintains

Ramifications-outcome

Culinary-the art of cooking food

Exodus- migration

Antidote-neutralizes the effects of something harmful

Sustenance-essential resources which includes food and water

Resistance-ability to withstand

Swankiest-luxury

Intricate-complex

Clambered-struggle

Shimmering-glow

Hitch a ride – take a ride from someone for free

Incentive-reward

Coax-influence or someone

Encampments-temporary camp

Inflated-expansion

SUMMARY

The lockdown imposed during the Covid-19 pandemic affected different people in different ways. With the possibility of being affected by a deadly disease looming large and the cities being under lockdown with minimum access to essential services, people faced many hardships during that time. Alia Allana in her essay, which was published in *The Atlantic*, brings out the story of Parle-G, India's most favoured biscuit and how it played a vital role in mitigating the sufferings of people during the pandemic and also how its own production and distribution faced huge setbacks.

Allana points out that Parle-G is not just a biscuit but a shared emotion among Indians. It comes in different kinds of packaging; the smallest being sold for as little as Rs.2. Launched in 1929 by Mohanlal Dayal Chauhan, Parle G biscuit was named after the Mumbai suburb, Vile Parle. From then on, the biscuit, which is truly Indian in its identity, has become synonymous with being Indian. Its consumers cut across class, regions and communities making it one of the biggest brands in India. People in elite neighbourhoods may dip the biscuit in tea and eat it and some others who are not very privileged might have it with water. But nonetheless, it has become an equalising factor in a very diverse country such as India. Allana aptly names it as India's 'comfort food'.

With less than four hours to make transformative decisions, Surendar Malik, head of one of the 135 factories of Parle-G biscuits, and his workers produced the much in demand biscuits through some very tough times during the pandemic. Lockdown rules, workers leaving for their villages, supply of ingredients, distribution and the fear of the virus made it impossible to produce the normal quantity of biscuits. Despite all that, the dedication of Malik and his workers to keep up the production rate was quite commendable. Prajapati's story reflects the

hardships faced by migrant workers during the lockdown. He was a construction worker in Gurgaon and when the lockdown was announced, he had no work and ran out of money and food. He decided to go back to his village 600 miles away with his wife and two small kids. They walked and hitched rides and reached home. During the arduous journey, Parle-G biscuits and food distributed by volunteers sustained the family.

An instant source of energy, easy to carry and very affordable, Parle-G biscuits are one of the most-loved and popular brands of India. Most people have an emotional connect with the biscuit. It's universal appeal across income-groups has helped it to endure as a successful food product.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPREHESSION

1. Who was Malik and how was he connected to Parle-G?
2. Why does Malik say that he had never heard of a 'lockdown'?
3. What happened at the Parle-G factory on the day the lockdown was announced?
4. Who was the founder of Parle-G and how did he come up with the name?
5. How did Prajapati reach his village?
6. The author believes that Parle-G is an equaliser. Would you agree?
7. How did Parle-G biscuits help the author when she was abroad?
8. During the pandemic, why were biscuits classified as an essential commodity?
9. Explain why Parle-G is an enduring brand in India.
10. What is your comfort food? How is it significant in your life?

VOCABULARY EXERCISE 1

Pick out words from the text for each of these pictures.



1.



2.



3.



4.



5.

6.



7.



8.



9.



UNIT IV

Writing, Reading and Listening

WRITING

1. Writing a Postcard – Places and experiences

It's important to stay connected to family and friends, and writing a postcard is a simple and meaningful way to do it. In the late 1800s, people began sending “mailing cards” to one another in beautifully decorated envelopes, which often showed a special landmark or a signature of the place it was sent from. The period from 1907 to 1915 is known as the “golden age of the postcard,” and it's when the divided design on the back of the card was created, introducing the postcards that we know today.

That divided back—with room for a message on the left and the address on the right—is essential to understanding how to write on a postcard. The space for a message is much more limited than in a letter (or any digital correspondence), so you need to choose your words wisely. A good postcard warms the reader and gets straight to the message.

Postcards are ultimately a way to send a snapshot, both literally and figuratively. They include pictures, and they have just enough space for you to share a little slice of life without going into too much detail. Because they aren't a necessity, they're a way to tell people you're thinking of them, surprise them from exotic or exciting locations, and create an instant memory that they can keep for years to come. Postcards may seem like a thing of the past, but perhaps it's time for a revival. Before you get started, here's what you need to know to write and send the perfect postcard.

Postcards are small, so get right to the point. Think of it as an opportunity to send a snapshot of your trip, hometown, or day-to-day life wherever you are.

Here are some ideas for things you might include:

- ❖ Write a quick list of five interesting facts you've learned about where you are.
- ❖ Give a local traveling tip.
- ❖ Share a funny or sweet anecdote from your life during the past few days.
- ❖ Share interesting news.
- ❖ Describe what you're doing or seeing right at the moment you're writing the card.
- ❖ Start with a simple greeting, a life update, or an observation that made you think of the person.

2. Write a postcard to your parents while you are on a college trip to a place with historical significance.

[illegible]

- **Compiled from online sources**

2. Data Presentation

Writing a brief report based on graphs and charts

A graph is a visual representation of data or information. It helps us understand and analyse different trends, patterns, or comparisons in a clear and organized way.

A report describing a graph is a way to explain and share information about a graph you see.

When you write a report about a graph, you look at the different parts of the graph and describe what you see. You talk about the important points, like the highest or lowest values, the trends or patterns you notice, or any comparisons between different parts of the graph.

Writing a report describing a graph helps you understand and communicate the information in the graph to others. It's like telling a story about the graph and what it shows.

Basic guidelines to write a report on graphs and charts

Title

- Give a suitable title that describes the graph/chart.

Introduction

- Start by explaining what the survey is about, who did it, and when.

Example: "This report tells us about a survey on [topic]."

- Use the passive to do this:

Example: The survey was done in [month/ year]/ by [organization/ person]

Main findings

- Begin with the most important discovery in the first sentence.

Example: "The most important thing we learned from the survey is that [state the discovery]."

- Use numbers and facts to support your main finding. Use words like "but," "different," or "compared to" to talk about contrasting information.
- If there is more than one topic or discovery, talk about each one in a different paragraph.
- Use words like "but," "different," or "while" to show contrasting information.
- Use simple words and phrases like "most people," "almost two-thirds," or "a lot" to describe numbers.

Conclusion

- Explain what you think the survey results mean using phrases like "show," "seem," or "tell us."

Questions to ask yourself while writing a report based on graphs and charts

1. What is the information about?
2. What do the numbers on each axis represent?

3. What changes do the lines show?
4. How can the lines be compared to each other?
5. Which feature of the lines stands out most?
6. What conclusions can be drawn from the graph?

It is important to note that you must not add any information that is not given in the graph while describing it. So, remember that opinions, outside information, inferences must all be avoided.

Writing the report

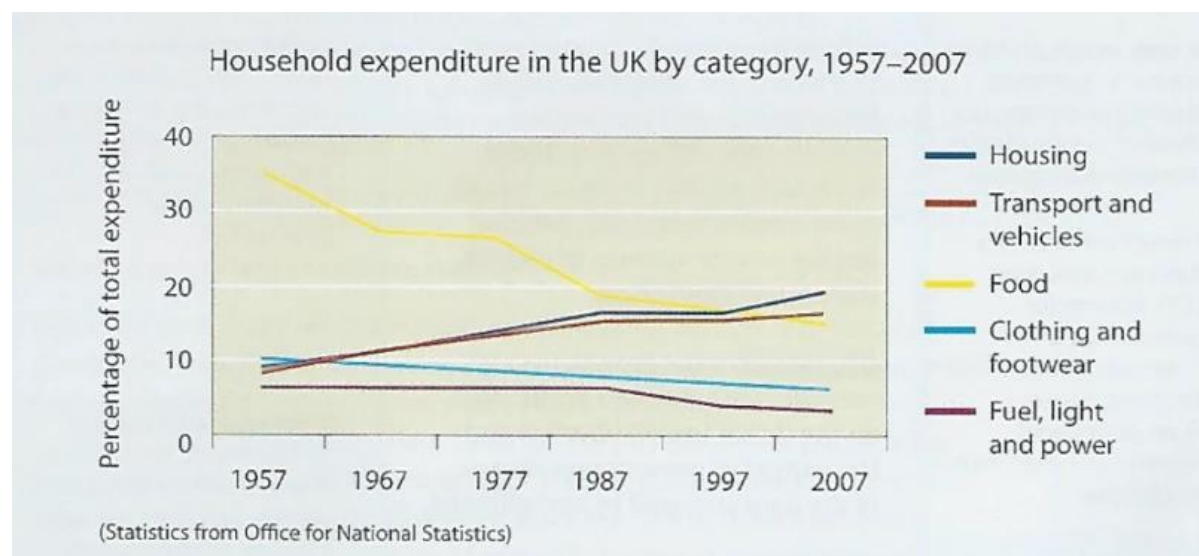
- Language: Accuracy and clarity are the essential features of a good report. The language you use should be plain and simple, but academic in style.
- Vocabulary: Use appropriate vocabulary to describe the graph given
- Organization: Organize the information so that you highlight the main trends or features. There is usually more than one suitable way of doing this.

Tips for writing reports

Make sure that you:

- write a title that shows what the report is about
- divide the report into clear paragraphs with subheadings, if needed
- do NOT use contractions or informal words
- use the correct verb tenses, word forms and punctuation
- write in a language that is simple and easy to understand

Sample 1



Report

The graph shows what proportion of their total expenditure households in the UK spent, over a fifty year period, in five different categories: housing; transport and vehicles; food; clothing and footwear; and fuel, light and power.

Between 1957 and 2007 expenditure in all five categories changed to some extent, but the most marked change was in the food category. At the beginning of the period the proportion of expenditure on food was more than three times as high as that in all the other categories, representing more than thirty per cent of total household expenditure. However, by 2007 this figure had more than halved to around fifteen per cent, and was slightly less than expenditure on both housing and transport.

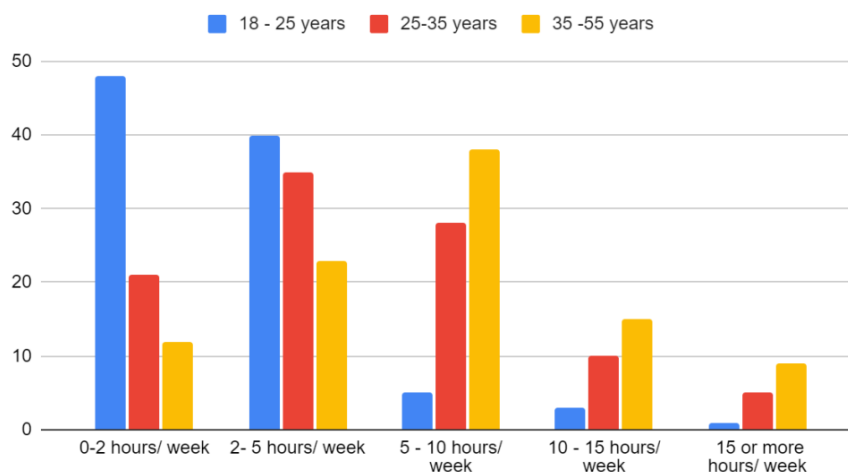
The two other areas where proportions of expenditure fell over the period are clothing and footwear, and fuel, light and power. However, the changes here were much less dramatic. Expenditure on the former dropped steadily from ten per cent to five per cent, and on the latter from six per cent to three per cent. For most of the fifty-year period, these categories used up a significantly smaller proportion of the household budget than the others.

In two categories, housing and transport, the proportions of expenditure almost doubled, rising from nine and eight per cent to nineteen and sixteen per cent respectively. Thus, by the end of the period, the highest proportion of household expenditure went on housing, and the lowest on fuel, light and power.

In conclusion, the graph shows that the patterns of spending in UK households changed to some extent over the period 1957 to 2007, the part of the budget spent on food showing the most marked change.

Sample 2

How many hours a week do you spend following the news?



This report presents the findings of a survey on the number of hours per week people usually spend following the news. The survey collected data from three different age groups: 18-25,

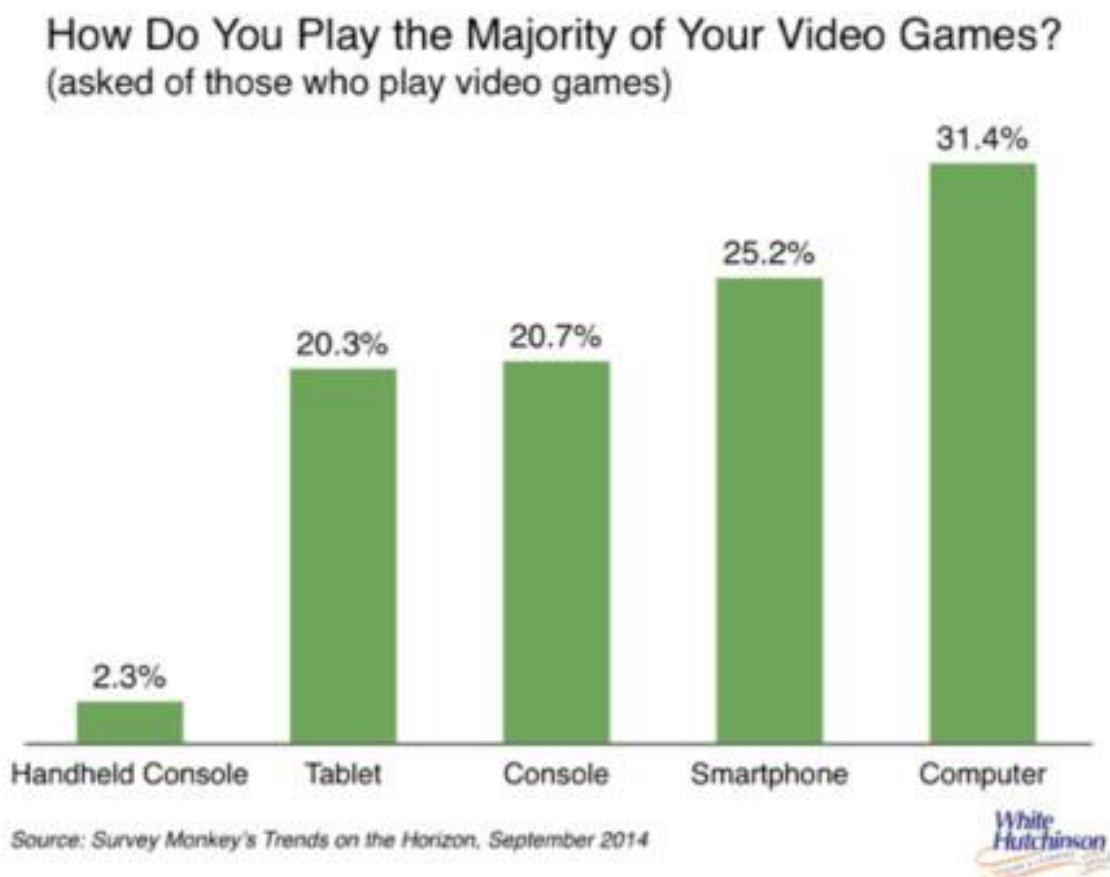
25-35 and 35-55. The purpose of this survey was to understand how much time per week people follow the news.

The results show that almost half of the people aged 18-25 spend 0-2 hour per week following the news. In contrast, only a tiny percentage reported spending 15 or more hours per week. Similarly, for the age group of 25-35, a large majority spend 2-5 hours per week, while a 5% respondents spend more than 15 hours per week following the news. In contrast, among the 35-55 group, the highest percentage (38%) reported that they follow the news 10-15 hours per week.

This survey suggests that younger age groups, particularly those aged 18-25 spend less time following the news compared to older age groups. Furthermore, it is a good idea to do more research to learn why people have different interests in the news.

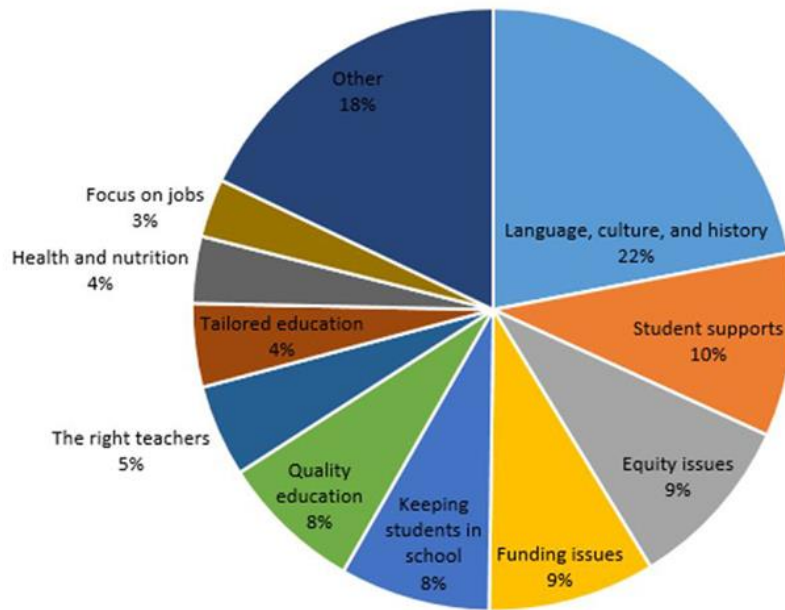
Activity

1. Write a brief report based on the graph given below.



Report

2. 500 students were surveyed on what is the most important issue in education. These were their responses. Write a report based on the pie chart given below.



Report

- Compiled from online sources

3. Profile – Biographical Sketches

Life and achievements of remarkable people

A biographical sketch paints an abbreviated picture of someone's life. It can be written about someone else's life or your own life. If you're writing about someone else, then you must explain who the person is and highlight their major achievements. If the biographical sketch is about you, the same criteria apply, in addition to the goal of presenting yourself in a positive light. Below, you'll find tips on writing a biographical sketch — also known as a bio-sketch — in order to keep people engaged and make others want to know more about the subject.

1. Remember Your Purpose

Biographical sketches usually provide an account of a person's life and include core information. If you're writing a bio-sketch about someone else, you'll want to focus on the following basic information: full name, date/place of birth, family background, education, occupation, and major accomplishments.

2. Structure your sketch:

Create a rough outline for the biographical sketch, organizing your information into clear sections. A standard structure can include:

- Introduction: A very short description of the person, incorporating major highlights.
- Early Life and Family Background: Where and when was a famous person born? Describe their family and upbringing.
- Education and Influences: What education did a particular person receive, and who were their major influences during these formative years?
- Career Beginnings: How did a person start their career, and what early challenges did they face?
- Major Achievements: What are the key accomplishments in their professional times, and how did they achieve them?
- Personal Life: What significant personal relationships did they have, and how did these relationships influence their living?
- Overcoming Adversity: What major obstacles did a person encounter, and how did they overcome them?
- Impact and Legacy: What lasting impact did they have on their field, community, or the world, and how are they remembered today?
- Character and Values: What were the person's core values and beliefs, and how did these shape their actions and decisions?
- Inspirational Moments: Share an inspiring story or moment from their experiences that reflect their character and influence.
- Historical and Social Context: What historical events or social conditions shaped their existence and work, and how did they interact with and influence these broader contexts?

3. Be Concise

It's best to aim for approximately 500 words or less in these sketches. That's equivalent to about one standard, single-spaced page. Remember, as a "sketch," this is going to be a condensed version of a fuller biography.

4. Highlight Achievements and Influences

Try to highlight notable achievements that will impress the audience and make the subject a more memorable one. Mention how these accomplishments affected the subject's life. Likewise, you can also incorporate personal influences into the sketch.

5. Formal language

Write the biographical sketch in third person and maintain a formal tone. Avoid using slang or informal language.

6. Arrange Your Information

Once you've gathered all the necessary information to compose a biographical sketch, it's time to format your facts. Will you retell the person's life in chronological order? Or, will you lead with their major achievements and then circle back to tell their full story? Decide on an interesting way to structure your sketch.

7. Review and revise:

Proofread your sketch carefully to check for grammar, syntax, and punctuation errors. Make revisions as necessary to ensure the final draft is polished and well-organised.

Sample 1

Leonard Bernstein, American conductor, composer and educator.

Leonard Bernstein (August 25, 1918-October 14, 1990) will forever be remembered for his contributions to the world of entertainment. The world-renowned, award-winning American composer, conductor and pianist enjoyed a long and storied career that encompassed concert halls around the world and tremendous success in theatre, television and motion pictures. His contributions to Broadway, motion pictures and the world of music changed the entertainment industry forever.

In the early days of the Massachusetts native's professional career, he served with the New York Philharmonic as assistant conductor. His incredible talent was immediately recognized. He began composing symphonies and Broadway musicals. During the 1940s, he composed the symphonies *Jeremiah*, *Age of Anxiety* and the Broadway musical *On the Town*. During the 1950s, he composed more Broadway musicals, including *Wonderful Town*, *Candid*, and the internationally-acclaimed *West Side Story*. Shortly after completing *West Side Story*, in 1958, Bernstein was named music director for the New York Philharmonic, a role he held until 1967.

Bernstein's career continued to expand and grow even more successful as he left his mark on the world of music as a composer, conductor, educator, and author. During his decade-spanning career, Bernstein traveled the world bringing the joy of music to audiences everywhere. He served as guest conductor for many major symphonies, including the Vienna Philharmonic and the Berlin Philharmonic. He worked as an educator at Boston's Tanglewood Music Center and Brandeis University in Waltham, Massachusetts. He also published two books of essays, *Joy of Music* and *Infinite Variety of Music*.

His later works include the dance drama *Dybbuk*, the musicals *Mass: A Theatre Piece for Singers, Players and Dancers* and *1600 Pennsylvania Avenue*, and the opera *A Quiet Place*. Bernstein was recognized with numerous awards throughout his career, including two Tony Awards, seven Primetime Emmy Awards and 16 Grammys. He was also recognized with a coveted Kennedy Center Honors Award. Early in his career, he was nominated for an Academy Award for the score of *On the Waterfront*. Bernstein never stopped composing, continuing to create and perform until just a few months before he passed away in October 1990. His final performance as a conductor was at Tanglewood Music Center in August 1990.

Sample 2

Will Smith (born September 25, 1968, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, U.S.) is an American actor and musician whose charisma and quick wit helped him transition from rap music to a successful career in acting. Smith's notable films include the blockbusters, *Bad Boys* (1995), *Independence Day* (1996), and *Men in Black* (1997). For his work in *King Richard* (2021), he received the Academy Award for best actor.

Music and TV

Smith began his career as a musician along with his schoolmate Jeffrey Townes, calling themselves as DJ Jazzy Jeff and the Fresh Prince. The hip-hop duo released their first single, "Girls Ain't Nothing but Trouble," in 1986, later followed by the album *Rock the House*. In 1988 the group released the groundbreaking single "Parents Just Don't Understand," which went on to win a Grammy Award (the first Grammy ever presented in the rap performance category). The television sitcom *The Fresh Prince of Bel-Air*, which began in 1990, was loosely based on Smith's real-life persona. It ran on NBC for six successful seasons and during its run Smith garnered two Golden Globe Award nominations and served as an executive producer for the final season.

Movie stardom: *Bad Boys*, *Independence Day*, and *Ali*

Buoyed by his small-screen success, Smith expanded into cinema with *Where the Day Takes You* (1992). His first leading role was in the film version of John Guare's successful stage play *Six Degrees of Separation* (1993). The action comedy-thriller *Bad Boys* (1995), however, proved to be the turning point in his film career. While the movie was not a critical success, it made more than \$100 million worldwide, proving Smith's star power. In 1996 he starred in that year's top-grossing movie, *Independence Day* followed by *Men in Black*, the next year. Also in 1997 Smith released his first solo album, *Big Willie Style*, which included the hit "Gettin' Jiggy wit It," and he followed it two years later with *Willennium*. After starring in the dramatic thriller *Enemy of the State* (1998), Smith continued to demonstrate his remarkable versatility as an actor, playing an enigmatic golf caddy in *The Legend of Bagger Vance* (2000); the boxer Muhammad Ali in the biopic *Ali* (2001), for which he received an Academy Award nomination. The next year he starred in *The Pursuit of Happyness*, and his performance as a single father who overcomes adversity earned him a second Oscar nomination for best actor. *I Am Legend* (2007), *Hancock* (2008) and *Seven Pounds* (2008) are some of his other films with varied themes and styles.

Later films and Oscar win

His explorations in to the cinematic forms continued into the twenty-first century which earned him lead roles in films such as *After Earth* (2013), *Concussion* (2015), *Collateral Beauty* (2016) and *Bad Boys for Life* (2020). In 2021 Smith played the title role in *King Richard*, a biopic about the father of tennis stars Serena and Venus Williams. For his performance, Smith received the Oscar for best actor in 2022.

His acting career thrives and he remains one of the most successful actors in Hollywood.

Activity**Write a bio-sketch of:**

1. A sportsperson
2. An actor
3. A musician

READING

READING COMPREHENSION

Descriptive Passages

1. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

In Kenya, martial eagles hunt lion cubs for lunch

In December 2012, tour guides in Kenya's Maasai Mara National Reserve witnessed a series of killings targeting one of the savannah's top predators. An adult martial eagle followed a pride of lions for weeks, waiting for the right time to swoop in and kill three cubs in total. "This is an eagle really looking at these lions and thinking, 'I'm going to systematically hunt these lions,'" says R. Stratton Hatfield, a Ph.D. candidate at Wageningen University and Research in the Netherlands.

While the supposed kings of the jungle may dominate the land around them, this incident and others like it show that African lions (*Panthera leo*) may not always sit on top of the food chain when it comes to the skies. In fact, Hatfield and his colleagues recently reported in *Ecology and Evolution* that martial eagles (*Polemaetus bellicosus*) likely prey on lion cubs when the opportunity arose. Martial eagles' wingspans can exceed six feet. Adult females weigh more than 10 pounds, while adult males typically weigh around seven pounds. Though comparable in size and ecology to golden eagles, the species often kills larger prey. The birds swoop in and dig their razor-like talons into their prey's spine at the back of their skull, sometimes taking out young impalas or gazelles far above their weight class. "[Their talons] are just massive killing utensils," Hatfield says. "From a predator perspective, they are impressive in what they're able to do."

Hatfield's team only recently realized the birds also preyed on other predators. The team collected seven records, including the 2012 incident, that describe martial eagles preying on lion cubs, resulting in the deaths of nine cubs and one near miss. Most of these episodes probably involve larger females, Hatfield suspects, though two records included juveniles preying on cubs.

In the one failed killing, a martial eagle swoops in to snatch a six-week-old cub right next to its mother. The lioness spots the approaching danger, and "literally leaps in the air to try to take the martial out of the sky," Hatfield describes. "You can just see the lioness's eyes lock onto something, then she crouches and launches." The eagle dodged the counterattack, and didn't get the cub, but the whole maneuver "was just stupid." Hatfield speculates that the raptor didn't see the lioness. Episodes like this are so dangerous for the eagle, "you wonder if they are doing something ever just for fun," he says.

Amy Dickman, a conservation biologist at Oxford University in the U.K., isn't surprised that eagles will go after cubs again and again if the strategy proves successful. She also leads Lion

Landscapes, a nonprofit focused on coexistence of humans and wildlife in Kenya and Tanzania, and says the conclusions of Hatfield's team "seem sound."

Martial eagles aren't picky when it comes to big cats. Some have taken cheetah and leopard kittens, as well. Hatfield also notes the risk probably goes both ways—lions could and probably have hunted adult eagles or nests. At least one YouTube video shows a leopard killing a martial eagle. "The relationships between top predators at the top of the [food] pyramid are complicated," Hatfield says.

Martial eagles are considered endangered by the International Union for Conservation of Nature, and Hatfield hopes that studies like this bring more attention to their plight. Like other large raptors in Africa, the species faces habitat loss, poaching for parts, electrocution on power lines and persecution. "We are all so focused on the elephant and lion and rhino," Hatfield says. "A lot of these big eagles and vultures are going to go extinct right in front of our eyes."

- In the first sentence of the passage, the word 'predator' refers to:
a. tiger b. lion c. martial eagle d. leopard
- Which part of the body does the martial eagle use to attack its prey?
a. wings b. talon c. skull d. beak
- Martial eyes prey on _____.
a. calves b. snakes c. cubs d. zebras
- Who is Amy Dickman and what was her opinion of the study conducted by Stratton Hatfield?
- Describe the physical characteristics of the martial eagle.
- What event was observed by the tour guides at a national reserve in Kenya?
- Why are martial eagles endangered?
- African lions are established at the top of the food chain. (True/false)
- Complete the sentence with the right option.
The old woman looked him up and down with her _____ 's eye.
a. sharp b. piercing c. pigeon d. raptor
- Pick a word from the passage that is a synonym of the word, *risk*

2. Read the passage and answer the questions

Mpox

Mpox is an infectious disease that can cause a painful rash, enlarged lymph nodes, fever, headache, muscle ache, back pain and low energy. Most people fully recover, but some get very sick. Mpox is caused by the monkeypox virus (MPXV). A global outbreak of Mpox began in 2022 and continues to this day, including in some African countries. The natural reservoir of the virus is unknown, but various small mammals such as squirrels and monkeys are susceptible.

Transmission

Mpox spreads from person to person mainly through close contact with someone who has mpox, including members of a household. Close contact includes skin-to-skin and even face-to-face with someone who has mpox (such as talking or breathing close to one another, which can generate infectious respiratory particles). People can also contract mpox from contaminated objects such as clothing or linen, through needle injuries in health care, or in community settings such as tattoo parlours. During pregnancy or birth, the virus may be passed to the baby. Contracting mpox during pregnancy can be dangerous for the fetus or newborn infant and can lead to loss of the pregnancy, stillbirth, death of the newborn, or complications for the parent.

Animal-to-human transmission of mpox occurs from infected animals to humans from bites or scratches, or during activities such as hunting, skinning, trapping, cooking, playing with carcasses or eating animals. The animal reservoir of the monkeypox virus remains unknown and further studies are underway.

Signs and symptoms

Mpox causes signs and symptoms which usually begin within a week but can start 1–21 days after exposure. Symptoms typically last 2–4 weeks but may last longer in someone with a weakened immune system. Common symptoms of mpox are rash, fever, sore throat, headache, muscle aches, back pain, low energy and swollen lymph nodes. For some people, the first symptom of mpox is a rash, while others may have fever, muscle aches or sore throat first.

The mpox rash often begins on the face and spreads over the body, extending to the palms of the hands and soles of the feet. It can also start on other parts of the body where contact was made. It starts as a flat sore, which develops into a blister filled with liquid that may be itchy or painful. People with mpox can pass the disease on to others until all sores have healed and a new layer of skin has formed. Some people can be infected without developing any symptoms. Although getting mpox from someone who is asymptomatic (not showing symptoms) has been reported, information is still limited on how common it is.

Children, pregnant women and people with weak immune systems, including people living with HIV that is not well controlled, are at higher risk for serious illness and death due to complications from mpox.

Some people with mpox can become very sick and can possibly lose their lives. For example, the skin can become infected with bacteria, leading to abscesses or serious skin damage. Other complications include pneumonia; corneal infection with loss of vision; pain or difficulty swallowing; vomiting and diarrhoea causing dehydration or malnutrition; and various secondary infections.

Diagnosis

Identifying mpox can be difficult because other infections and conditions can look similar. For these reasons, testing is key for people to get care as early as possible and prevent severe illness and further spread. The preferred laboratory test for mpox is detection of viral DNA by polymerase chain reaction (PCR). The best diagnostic specimens are taken directly from the rash – skin, fluid or crusts – collected by vigorous swabbing. In the absence of skin lesions, testing can be done using swabs of the throat.

Treatment and vaccination

The goal of treating mpox is to take care of the rash, manage pain and prevent complications. Early and supportive care is important to help manage symptoms and avoid further problems. Getting an mpox vaccine can help prevent infection (pre-exposure prophylaxis). It is recommended for people at high-risk of getting mpox, especially during an outbreak.

Some antivirals have received emergency use authorization in some countries and are being evaluated in clinical trials. To date, there is no proven effective antiviral treatment for mpox. It is a priority to continue evaluation of therapeutics in robust clinical trials and to focus on optimizing supportive care for patients.

1. Humans contract Mpox from infected animals by _____.
 - a. travelling with animals
 - b. sharing the same space
 - c. bites and scratches
 - d. adopting them
2. Which is not a complication of Mpox?
 - a. loss of eyesight
 - b. stroke
 - c. pneumonia
 - d. dehydration
3. Which is not a symptom of Mpox?
 - a. swollen lymph nodes
 - b. cough
 - c. fever
 - d. breathlessness
4. Arrange the following sentences in the right order.
 - a. Then it spreads to the other parts of the body.
 - b. Develops into a blister filled with bloody liquid.
 - c. It starts as a flat sore.
 - d. The rash first appears on the face.
5. How are the symptoms of Mpox disguised?
6. How does the disease spread from person to person?
7. What are the complications of Mpox if a pregnant woman gets affected?
8. Mpox is a bacterial disease. (True/false)
9. Complete the sentence with the correct option.

Staff must follow standard _____ procedures when a customer pays by credit card.

 - a. authorization
 - b. sales
 - c. final
 - d. festival

10. Find the meaning of the word, *prophylaxis*.

3. Read the following passage and answer the questions

Silk Route

It was around the start of the first century before the Common Era (100 BCE) that the many different links in a long trading chain came together to form what we now call the Silk Route. For the first time, European gold could buy the luxuries of China, including the silk that gives the route its name. But it was a difficult exchange: as Fa Xian describes, the route crossed some dangerous terrain and the traders also faced the possibility of attack from marauding tribesmen and bandits. The Silk Route was safest and most successful when its paths were protected by powerful empires. Thus, the history of these empires, their rise and fall, directly affected the fortunes of the Silk Route, from its early origins until its final decline around 1500 CE, when the sea routes took over as the main trade links between East and West.

In its turn, the Silk Route had a deep effect on history. Before its coming, the Chinese and the Europeans had no idea of each other's existence! Along the paths of the Silk Route travelled not only goods but knowledge- knowledge of different lands and people, of their cultures and beliefs. It is this knowledge that has been the Silk Route's greatest influence on history and its most lasting legacy for us today.

The eastern starting point of the Silk Route was Changan (modern day Xi'an), the ancient capital of the Chinese Empire. From here the traders and their caravans of camels set out west along the Gansu Corridor, a strip of fertile land which stretched over 800 kilometres to Dunhuang. This city was at the western end of the Great Wall of China, which the Chinese had built to protect themselves from the war-like tribes to the north. For the ancient Chinese, Dunhuang was considered the edge of the civilized world. The next stage of the Silk Road crossed one of the most inhospitable stretches of terrain on the surface of the globe: the Tarim Basin. This vast natural basin today forms part of the north-eastern Chinese province known as Xinjiang. It is over 1500 kilometres long and 750 kilometres wide and is surrounded on three sides by mountain ranges rising to over 6000 metres. Its eastern end opens into the Gobi Desert. In the midst of the Tarim Basin lies the Taklamakan, a desert of high, shifting sand dunes that over the centuries have buried entire cities. Mongolian, Turkic, Iranian and Chinese people inhabit this desolate region. They live in small, isolated cities on the edge of the Taklamakan at the foot of the surrounding mountains. The patches of fertile ground around these cities are watered by the spring torrents from the melting glaciers of the peaks.

Travellers on the Silk Road could choose to skirt north or south around the Taklamakan Desert, covering the long hazardous journey in a series of stages from oasis to oasis. This part of the journey was very hard. Temperatures could range from -20°C to over 40°C and swirling sandstorms were a constant hazard. From the southern path, it was possible to cross over the Karakoram Mountains into India, but the main north and south trails met up again at Kashgar, which marked the half-way point of the Silk Route. Still a thriving community today, this city

lies at the foot of the Pamir Mountains. These have peaks which rise to over 7500 metres. Their height and central position on the globe have led them to be called 'The Roof of the World'

The Silk Route caravans now had to cross one of the high passes over the Pamirs to continue their journey to the West. Here the trail often consisted of little more than narrow rock ledges, 4500 metres up along the sides of sheer cliffs. The caravaners, with their precious cargoes of silk, were forced to battle their way through snowstorms and faced the danger of avalanches and falling rocks- often with only the thought of the vast profit at the end of their journey to keep them going.

1. According to the passage, which city is still thriving in China?
a. Pamir b. Kashgar c. Changan d. Taklamakan
2. Which mountain is called the 'roof of the world'?
a. Xingjiang b. Himalayas c. Pamirs d. Dunhuang
3. Which of the following threats the caravaners did not face during their journey?
a. snow b. extreme heat c. bandits d. locusts
4. Arrange the following sentences in the right order.
a. The Silk Route caravans went across Pamirs, one of the high passes to continue their journey.
b. The route crossed into Tarim Basin, one of the most inhospitable terrains on earth.
c. Its east end opens into Gobi Desert.
d. The Eastern starting point of the Silk Route was Changan.
e. The Silk Route stretched on to the Gansu Corridor.
5. How did the Silk Route get its name?
6. What were the risks the caravaners faced along the Silk Route?
7. Describe the Tarim Basin.
8. Silk Route declined because of the invention of railways. (True/false)
9. Complete the sentence with the right option.
We have a list of people ready to _____ the island.
a. join b. inhabit c. accommodate d. deliver
10. Find a word from the passage that means 'threat'.

4. Read the following passage and answer the questions.

AI Tool Decodes Brain Cancer's Genome During Surgery

Scientists have designed an AI tool that can rapidly decode a brain tumor's DNA to determine its molecular identity during surgery — critical information that under the current approach can take a few days and up to a few weeks. Knowing a tumour's molecular type enables neurosurgeons to make decisions such as how much brain tissue to remove and whether to place tumour-killing drugs directly into the brain — while the patient is still on the operating table.

Accurate molecular diagnosis — which details DNA alterations in a cell — during surgery can help a neurosurgeon decide how much brain tissue to remove. Removing too much when the tumour is less aggressive can affect a patient’s neurologic and cognitive function. Likewise, removing too little when the tumour is highly aggressive may leave behind malignant tissue that can grow and spread quickly.

“Right now, even state-of-the-art clinical practice cannot profile tumours molecularly during surgery. Our tool overcomes this challenge by extracting thus-far untapped biomedical signals from frozen pathology slides,” said study senior author Kun-Hsing Yu, assistant professor of biomedical informatics in the Blavatnik Institute at HMS. Knowing a tumour’s molecular identity during surgery is also valuable because certain tumours benefit from on-the-spot treatment with drug-coated wafers placed directly into the brain at the time of the operation, Yu said. “The ability to determine intraoperative molecular diagnosis in real time, during surgery, can propel the development of real-time precision oncology,” Yu added.

The standard intraoperative diagnostic approach used now involves taking brain tissue, freezing it, and examining it under a microscope. A major drawback is that freezing the tissue tends to alter the appearance of cells under a microscope and can interfere with the accuracy of clinical evaluation. Furthermore, the human eye, even when using potent microscopes, cannot reliably detect subtle genomic variations on a slide.

The new AI approach overcomes these challenges. The tool, called CHARM (Cryosection Histopathology Assessment and Review Machine), is freely available to other researchers. It still has to be clinically validated through testing in real-world settings and cleared by the FDA before deployment in hospitals, the research team said.

Cracking cancer’s molecular code

Recent advances in genomics have allowed pathologists to differentiate the molecular signatures — and the behaviours that such signatures portend — across various types of brain cancer as well as within specific types of brain cancer. For example, glioma — the most aggressive brain tumour and the most common form of brain cancer — has three main subvariants that carry different molecular markers and have different propensities for growth and spread.

The new tool’s ability to expedite molecular diagnosis could be particularly valuable in areas with limited access to technology to perform rapid cancer genetic sequencing. Beyond the decisions made during surgery, knowledge of a tumour’s molecular type provides clues about its aggressiveness, behaviour, and likely response to various treatments. Such knowledge can inform post-operative decisions.

1. What is CHARM and what does it do?
2. Who conducted the study that led to the development of the new AI tool?
3. How have recent approaches in genomics enabled medical experts in understanding brain cancer?

4. How does accurate molecular diagnosis help a surgeon?
5. Why is freezing a brain tissue not very effective?
6. Why is the new AI tool still not used in hospitals?
7. The new AI tool does not aid in post-operative treatments. (True/false)
8. Arrange the sentences in the right logical order.
 - a. It can rapidly decode a brain tumour's DNA to determine its molecular identity during surgery.
 - b. The new AI approach overcomes these challenges.
 - c. Knowing a tumour's molecular type enables neurosurgeons to make decisions such as how much brain tissue to remove.
 - d. The standard intraoperative diagnostic approach used now, which has its drawbacks, involves taking brain tissue, freezing it, and examining it under a microscope.
 - e. And whether to place tumour-killing drugs directly into the brain — while the patient is still on the operating table can also be determined.
9. Complete the sentence with the right option.
 The weather can get chilly and there is a _____ for rain.
 - a. possibility b. propensity c. penchant d. precipitation
10. Find the synonym for the word *violent* in the passage.

2. Short Stories

1. Read the following story and answer the questions.

Bad Blood

David and Emma gazed at each other across the table. The young couple were content: the meal was delicious, the candlelight was soft and the music captured the moment perfectly.

David looked at Emma's beautiful smile. All the pain of his last break-up, all his doubts and fears about love melted away. His hand reached out and touched hers nervously.

'I have something I want to ask you.' David searched her eyes to see if she guessed what was coming.

Her smile was reassuring. She squeezed his hand. 'You needn't worry. Whatever it is, I'm sure I'll say yes!'

A huge wave of excitement went through him as he prepared to ask the most important question of his life.

From the corner of the restaurant, a strange man watched them. He sat, stiff and unmoving, at his table, pretending to read a menu. But all the while, he stared with cold eyes at the young couple.

Back at their table, David suddenly felt his nerves return.

'Excuse me,' he said to Emma. He pushed his chair back and went to the toilet. As he looked at his reflection in the mirror, he took a deep breath and told himself: 'Come on, David, come on! You can do this, mate! She's crazy about you!'

He nodded at himself and, feeling braver, he stepped outside the bathroom. He bumped straight into the extremely tall man, who was waiting by the door. The man's eyes were a cold, bright blue and his face was pale with a sharp, pointed nose and thin, pale lips.

'Oh, sorry!' said David.

'Which one?' the man hissed. He spoke with a strange, heavy accent that David had never heard before.

For a moment, David was confused until he realised what the other man meant.

'Er ... oh! This one!' said David, helpfully. 'This is the men's toilet!'

David went back into the restaurant, reaching into his pocket for the small, square-shaped box. He was now filled with courage. He was going to ask her.

The taxi ride home was heaven. The happy pair discussed their future life together and shared sweet words of admiration.

'The night I proposed!' said David.

'The night I accepted!' replied Emma.

'Just think, a whole life together!'

'Caring, sharing, ...' he began.

'... loving, giving!' Emma finished his sentence.

They smiled at each other in love and excitement.

'You are so wonderful!' sighed David.

'And you're absolutely gorgeous!' said Emma. 'I've never met anyone so lovely and kind! I'm so happy I could sing!'

But as they entered their block of flats, holding hands, a tall figure watched them from the shadows.

'Which one?' he whispered to himself.

He watched the building, waiting for a light to come on and give away which flat was theirs. One minute went by ... two ... there it was! The light went on in a third-floor window. Emma was briefly visible as she closed the curtains.

How often had the sharp-toothed watcher stood on corners like this observing his victims? Many corners! Many windows! A thin smile spread across his pale lips. He moved out of the shadows to the door and pressed all the doorbells. The vampire was always grateful for these modern flats. Sooner or later someone would let you in, thinking it was a pizza delivery. Silly humans! It was a kind of invitation – and that was all he needed to enter a home.

As he climbed the stairs to the third floor and walked soundlessly down the hall, he could hear the young couple's laughter and conversation. As he pressed his ear against the door, he could hear their conversation. Young love made for the sweetest blood; it was so full of life and energy.

'I feel as if I'm in a film,' she was saying.

'More like a dream,' he replied.

'Yes, a dream. How lucky we are!'

'Guess who I'll be dreaming about tonight!' he teased.

'Who? Who?'

'Her hair smells of roses! She's like an angel!'

Their dream was about to become a nightmare, the vampire thought. He burst through the door and stood there with a cruel expression, showing his sharp teeth. The couple screamed and held each other in terrified silence. The vampire smelled the tension and tasted the fear. This was how he liked it. Fear made the blood even sweeter.

'There's my wallet! On the table, there! Take it!' said David. 'Take anything you want!'

'Indeed, I will take anything I want!' the vampire replied.

'Fine! Fine! We won't stop you, I promise!' David cried.

'You won't! I promise!' replied the vampire.

As the light shone on the sharp, pointed teeth, the terrible realisation came to David and Emma at the same time.

'Look at his teeth! Is he ... ?'

'A vampire!!'

'Which one?' the vampire hissed. 'It can be ... only one!'

The couple's eyes were wide open and staring. Their mouths hung open in horror. They held each other's hands and their stomachs filled with fear.

'Already tonight,' continued the vampire. 'I have drunk from three. One more ... then ... I can ... sleep ... and feel young again.'

David felt a strong instinct as the vampire moved towards them. He stepped in front of Emma and protected his wife-to-be. Emma gratefully held on to his back.

The vampire was in no rush. Who best to attack? he asked himself. Which one?

'Thank you,' Emma whispered to David, 'for what you're doing for me.'

'Of course, darling. I'm here to protect you.' Pride swept over him as he said the words. He could fight this vampire. All he needed was a cross, or something to stab him through the heart. He looked around for something ...

'You're so selfless to offer yourself so bravely,' continued Emma, admiringly.

'Pardon?' asked David. 'What the hell are you talking about?'

'Oh!' said Emma. 'I just thought that with your love for me and everything ...'

David and the vampire stared at each other.

'Now, listen, Emma. There is no doubt about my love for you!'

'Really?' she replied, her voice heavy with disbelief.

'But you can't expect me to just throw away my life!'

'I wasn't saying you should!' she said. 'It's just one of our options, that's all!'

'Well, think of another one!' he argued. 'Why don't you offer yourself up for me!'

The mood in the room had certainly turned ugly. The vampire was displeased that the fear and love had turned into petty arguments.

Emma was furious. 'I hope you're joking!'

'Let's see how strong your love is!' he said, angrily.

'What a gentleman!'

'What a lovely woman I was planning to marry. Offering me up like a bone to a dog!'

'You said my hair smells of roses!' she cried.

'All right, all right! Calm down!' David was a little embarrassed to be having this argument in front of a stranger.

'I'm an angel, you said!' she carried on shouting.

'MUST... FEED!' shouted the vampire furiously as he came even closer. He was determined to make a quick kill and get to bed as soon as possible, away from this terrible pair.

His eyes opened wider and he showed his teeth. 'WHICH ... ONE?'

'HER!' said David, pointing at his future wife.

'HIM! HIM!' screamed Emma in rage. 'Please, take HIM!'

The vampire approached David.

'She's younger! Sweeter!' said David.

The vampire turned to Emma.

'He's bigger! There's more of him!' she said, pointing desperately.

Suddenly a wave of tiredness came over the vampire. He was centuries old, and listening to them was exhausting and depressing. How could he feel better by feeding on either of these pathetic creatures?

He looked down upon their terrified faces and cried, 'BAD BLOOD!'

And with that, he disappeared into the night air and left Emma and David alone together. Together, as they had promised, for the rest of their lives.

Story written by Clive Lane and adapted by Nicola Prentis.

1. Determine if the following statements are true or false.

- a. David and Emma knew the man was watching them.
- b. The vampire knew which one he wanted to kill.
- c. David misunderstood what the vampire meant outside the toilets.
- d. The couple invited the vampire into their flat.
- e. The vampire was happy to find a couple in love as it would make the blood taste nicer.
- f. At first, David liked the idea of being a hero and saving Emma.
- g. Emma offered to give herself to the vampire to save David.

h. The couple's feelings for each other were different by the end of the story.

2. Fill in the blanks with the right option from the box.

soundlessly felt disbelief exhausting selfless
was displeased with unmoving

1. The vampire sat at his table. (COMPLETELY STILL)
2. The vampire moved down the hall. (SILENTLY)
3. At first, Emma thought David was brave and
(THINKING OF OTHER PEOPLE INSTEAD OF HIMSELF)
4. Emma when David didn't offer himself to the vampire.
(COULDN'T BELIEVE IT)
5. The vampire how things had changed. (WASN'T
HAPPY ABOUT)
6. The vampire thought listening to the young couple was depressing and
..... (EXTREMELY TIRING)

3. Match the following.

- | | | |
|-------------------------|---|--|
| 1. an instinct | - | a. to look at someone or something for a long time |
| 2. selfless | - | b. making you feel less worried |
| 3. pathetic | - | c. to touch or crash into someone without meaning to |
| 4. to hiss | - | d. to say something in a loud, angry whisper |
| 5. petty | - | e. a natural feeling that helps you act quickly |
| 6. reassuring | - | f. caring about other people more than yourself |
| 7. to gaze | - | g. not important and not worth giving attention to |
| 8. to bump into someone | - | h. so useless or weak that it annoys you |

2. Read the following story and answer the questions

First star I see tonight

Dr Tomas Streyer looked around the control room at his team of scientists and engineers. He was pretending to be calm, but he was both excited and terrified. The next few minutes would be the starting point of years more research towards understanding the secrets of how the universe began.

He looked out of the window at the beautiful blue summer sky and took a deep breath.

'Ready,' he said, and pressed the first button, bringing to life the complicated computers and machines around them.

'Set,' he said, and pressed the second button, switching on the huge particle accelerator that lay in a huge underground laboratory, deep beneath the towns and fields of Switzerland.

'Go,' he said, at exactly twelve o'clock, and pressed the final button.

For a second, everything went absolutely black, as if he had gone blind. Tomas cried out in shock, but the lights were already on again. Whatever that was, it was not supposed to have happened.

'Everybody check the systems!' he ordered, but nothing seemed to be wrong with them. The particle accelerator was working, just as he had hoped it would.

'Look outside,' said Tomas's assistant in a frightened voice.

Instead of the perfect summer day of five minutes ago, the sky was darker than the blackest night. Not only had the sun disappeared, there weren't even any stars.

People were shouting and screaming, calling their families on the telephone, afraid they had all suddenly disappeared too. Tomas ignored their noise. He sat at the main computer and started reading the data from his experiment. Nothing there explained what was happening. He rushed for the exit, his team running behind him until they were all outside the laboratory building.

Everyone else in the research centre was outside, panicking and confused. They were using the screens and torches on their mobile phones to see where they were going, waving them around like giant fireflies.

Several people got in their cars and turned on the headlights, driving them to the entrance to make a small area of brightness in the dark for everybody to crowd together. When the automatic street lights turned on, some people cheered, but most of them were still frightened. Then, almost twenty minutes after Tomas had started his experiment, without warning the sun reappeared in the sky, warm and yellow, and the black sky turned blue again. Everyone started laughing and dancing around, and Tomas breathed a sigh of relief.

But later, hours later, when the real night fell again, no one was celebrating. Because although the moon rose as usual, there was not a star to be seen.

No one wanted to know what Tomas had intended to happen or what his research had actually been about. What did that matter? All they cared about was what had happened. He had stolen all the stars – or that's what the newspapers said he had done. And when they put him on trial before the International Criminal Court, that's what they charged him with: stealing the stars. He pleaded 'Not guilty'.

'Well, if you didn't steal the stars, Dr Streyer,' said the lawyer for the prosecution, 'what did you do?'

'As far as my experiment is concerned,' said Tomas, 'it didn't seem to do anything. The machine was working, that's all.'

'Taking the stars from the sky seems like nothing to you?' The lawyer looked around at the audience in the court. 'No one here would agree. No one in the world.'

'That's not what I meant,' said Tomas. 'What I know is that when the experiment started, there were suddenly no photons in the test room.'

'What? Photons? We aren't all scientists here! Speak plain English, Dr Streyer!'

'Light,' said Tomas. 'I mean, for just a moment it was as if there was no light in our laboratory, and then we saw it was dark outside as well until the daylight returned to normal.'

'Normal, Dr Streyer? Except for when ...' – the lawyer checked his notes – '... the sun went out for exactly 16 minutes and 40 seconds? Oh yes, the rest of the day was very normal. The night, on the other hand, hasn't been normal ever since.'

Tomas nodded sadly. 'I know. But you must believe me, nothing I did could possibly have removed the stars from existence!'

'So neither you nor your experiment stole the stars from us,' said the lawyer.

'No,' Tomas said.

'You just made it so that we can't see them any more.'

After a long pause, Tomas sighed. 'Yes.'

The lawyer raised an eyebrow. 'How is that any different?'

Tomas didn't have an answer, not one anyone would understand anyway, let alone believe. He had a theory, but it would take years to prove it. Instead, he changed his plea to 'guilty'.

The trial gave the world someone to blame for what it had lost, but sending Tomas to prison for years wouldn't change anything. Instead, at the end of their symbolic trial, they gave him a symbolic punishment.

Tomas was sentenced to work at the abandoned Extremely Large Telescope in Paranal, Chile. Nobody looked at the night sky now. No tourists climbed high mountains to see the edges of our galaxy, and no scientists asked for money to study the empty sky. All that passed through the night sky was the lonely moon, a handful of planets and the occasional comet. Looking up made people depressed.

Tomas thought it was fair. It was right that he should be punished, and working as an astronomer had become almost the same as prison. After a few years the world forgot about him, or at least decided to leave him alone. Every evening he would watch the sun go down. It vanished below the horizon exactly eight minutes and twenty seconds after it actually descended below the curve of the Earth. The laws of physics remained the same, much to Tomas's daily relief. Light still travelled at the same speed as it always had. He hadn't changed reality that much or, at least, he hoped he hadn't. If light travels at a certain speed, he thought, perhaps absence of light travels at the same speed.

Of course, there was no way to prove his theory. Not yet. And, alone in the observatory, Tomas had nobody to share it with anyway.

High in the mountains of Chile, Tomas continued to watch the night, his enormous telescope pointing towards a particular point of the sky, even though it was always just as empty as every other part. And each day, as the sun went down, he thought of the song his parents sang to him as a child:

*Star light, star bright,
First star I see tonight,
I wish I may, I wish I might,
Have the wish I wish tonight.*

For 1,596 black nights – nearly four and a half years – there was no change to the night sky. But that was OK. It didn't disprove Tomas's theory, it supported it. Tomas thought about the absence of light he had created and he imagined it like a wave, passing the sun and continuing out towards the edge of our galaxy and beyond. It would take 1,596 nights to pass the nearest

star, and another 1,596 nights for that star's light to reach the Earth again ... If the wave of darkness existed at all, of course. If his calculations were correct. If he was wrong, the stars really were gone forever.

...

And then one night, another 1,596 nights later, almost nine years after the disaster, Tomas looked up from his telescope and saw Alpha Centauri twinkling back at him.

The first star.

He wiped the tears from his eyes and made a wish. Billions of other people's wishes followed right after it.

Story written by Andrew Leon Hudson and adapted by Nicola Prentis.

1. Match the following words with their meanings.

- | | | |
|---------------------------|---|--|
| 1. the prosecution | - | a. a large machine that does physics experiments with particles |
| 2. symbolic | - | b. a ball of ice and dust that travels in space |
| 3. a galaxy | - | c. to state in a court of law that you are responsible for a crime |
| 4. a comet | - | d. the lawyers who try to prove someone is guilty of a crime |
| 5. a particle accelerator | | e. a particle of light |
| 6. to plead guilty | - | f. representing something but having no practical meaning |
| 7. to twinkle | - | g. a system of millions of stars |
| 8. a photon | - | h. to change from bright to less bright and back again, like stars appear to do when we look at them |

2. Circle the best answer.

1. What was the aim of Tomas's experiment?
 - a. to investigate the beginning of the universe
 - b. to investigate the speed of light
 - c. to hide the stars
 - d. to see how people behave when all the light goes out

2. Just after the experiment, who could explain what had happened?
 - a. Tomas
 - b. Tomas's assistant
 - c. the lawyer
 - d. no one

3. What could be seen after 20 minutes?
 - a. no light at all
 - b. the sun
 - c. the moon
 - d. the stars

4. At the end of the trial, what did Tomas admit?
 - a. He had stolen the stars.
 - b. He had hidden the stars.

- c. He didn't know what photons are.
- d. He had planned to steal the stars.

5. What was the problem with Tomas's theory?

- a. He didn't have the right equipment to prove it.
- b. It needed a long time to prove it right or wrong.
- c. He wasn't sure his theory was worth investigating.
- d. He didn't know how to do the calculations.

6. Why did it take almost nine years to see the first star?

- a. Tomas didn't look at the sky every night.
- b. Tomas was looking at the wrong place in the sky.
- c. It took nine years for Alpha Centauri's light to reach Earth.
- d. It took four and a half years for the darkness to pass Alpha Centauri and four and a half years for its light to reach Earth.

3. Write the correct form of the word in brackets.

1. Tomas breathed in when the lights came back on. (RELIEVE).
2. Tomas changed his to guilty in the end. (PLEADED)
3. Tomas was sure the stars were still in (EXIST)
4. Tomas thought his was fair. (PUNISH)
5. Tomas hoped his were correct. (CALCULATE)
6. There was a complete of light. (ABSENT)

3. Read the following story and answer the questions.

Frank's Last Case

Sergeant Frank Spike sat behind his desk and looked out of the window. Outside, cars moved slowly in the cold, grey rain. He looked down at the grey hairs on his arms. His round stomach pushed against the desk. This was his final month before he retired from the police. For Frank, his last day couldn't come too soon.

Frank felt angry as he thought about the money he would get when he retired. It wasn't enough money to pay for a short holiday on the cold and rainy east coast of England where he lived. It certainly wouldn't pay for his dream holiday – a luxury, round-the-world cruise.

Just then, Inspector Spencer came to Frank's desk. Spencer had perfect white teeth and he was always smiling. Three years earlier, Spencer had been promoted. Now he was an inspector at the young age of forty. Frank wasn't so lucky. He had worked for the police for forty years and he was still a sergeant. Frank knew he wasn't as handsome or as friendly as Spencer, sorry, *Inspector* Spencer. But Frank was a better policeman. Frank had 'a nose for crime' and Spencer didn't. That 'nose' meant Frank could think like a criminal and solve the most difficult crimes. As a result, the younger man often asked for Frank's help. In fact, it was the only time Spencer spoke to him.

'Hey, Frank, can I ask you something?' asked Spencer.

Frank wasn't surprised.

'Do you know who the Babbingtons are?' Spencer continued.

Everyone knew who the Babbingtons were. Ronald Babbington was the super-rich owner of Babbington Oil, and his wife Tabitha was a model. Together they loved showing how rich they were. They often appeared in magazines like *Hello!*, with their beautiful house and their collection of cars. Last month, Ronald had bought an enormous diamond for Tabitha. The diamond sat in a large gold and glass case at the end of a long, red carpet. There was an alarm system to keep it safe.

Spencer continued to explain.

'Someone told us about a plan to steal the Babbington diamond!'

Frank tried to look as though he was surprised.

'Peggy, the owner of the Dog and Duck pub, heard two local criminals making the plan,'

Spencer said. 'She asked us to keep her name secret, of course.'

'OK,' Frank said. He waited for the question he knew would come.

'So?' Spencer asked. 'What should we do? They haven't committed a crime yet.'

Frank looked out of the window. He remembered his retirement money. He didn't want to be alone in his retirement, but the money wouldn't even be enough to buy a cat.

The sound of a car outside brought him back to the conversation with Spencer. He put his fingers together under his chin to look as if he was thinking. In fact, he was, but not in the way Inspector Spencer expected.

'Listen, do this the clever way,' said Frank. 'Let them steal the diamond. If you catch them with the diamond, you can arrest them, no problem.'

'But, Frank,' said Spencer, 'we would need the Babbingtons to agree. And there are laws against trying to trick criminals like that, you know!'

'That's why you let them steal the diamond. Then, as if by chance, you stop them for driving too fast as they escape. Search the car and find the diamond. You don't need to tell anyone that we knew about their plan. And they'll go to prison.'

'Hmmm. OK.' Spencer was uncomfortable with the idea Frank was suggesting. But he knew it would work.

Frank continued, 'Of course, the officer who arrests them needs to be reliable.'

Spencer understood immediately.

'Are you sure you want to do it, Frank? It could be dangerous.'

'I'll take two young officers with me. But, yes, of course I want to do it.'

'Why?' asked Spencer. 'You're going to retire soon! Don't you want to take it easy?'

'That's exactly why I want to do it,' Frank replied. 'My last case will be my best!'

A few days later, Frank visited the Dog and Duck pub after work.

'Did you get it?' he asked Peggy as she gave him his drink.

'Yes. I have now got a perfect copy of the Babbington diamond,' she said. 'I told the glassmaker I was a big fan of the Babbingtons. And I said that my boyfriend wouldn't buy me a diamond of my own.'

'You need a new boyfriend,' said Frank. 'If I were your boyfriend, I'd buy you a diamond ring and take you on a long luxury cruise.'

'Oh, really?' she said and smiled.

Frank was sitting in the back seat of the police car. The car was hidden in a small road next to the Babbington house. In the front seats were two strong, young police officers.

At 23.30, a message came in on the police radio. The thieves, a man and a tall woman, had met outside the Dog and Duck pub. At 23.37, they got into a car. The man started the car and drove away from the pub.

At midnight, the thieves passed the hidden police car on the way to the Babbingtons' house. At 00.13, the woman climbed over one of the garden walls. A second hidden police team watched her climb over, while the man waited in the car.

At 00.20, the woman climbed back over the wall. She had an excited smile on her face. She ran back to the car. Smiling, the man waited for her to jump in and then they drove away.

Almost immediately, the thieves passed Frank's car. The young police officer in the driver's seat switched on the blue lights and followed them.

Inside the car, the thieves were afraid.

'What are they doing here?' the man shouted. 'You said you turned off the alarms!'

'Relax, I did,' she replied. 'Remember, the police don't know what we've done. Just be normal! We can walk away from this with the diamond.'

The man stopped the car and opened his window.

'Is there a problem, officer?' he asked. His face was red and shiny because he was so nervous.

'You were speeding. We'll need to give you a ticket. Can you both get out of the car, please?'

The man still looked nervous. One officer wrote the speeding ticket and the other stood close in case they ran away. Frank began to search the car.

'Hey! What's he doing?' the woman said. But she knew the game was over.

Frank breathed heavily as he started looking under the seats. His hand felt something smooth, hard and cold under the front passenger seat. *The Babbington diamond!* He took the diamond and put it in his jacket pocket. At the same time, with his other hand, he took something very similar out of his trouser pocket. He held it up.

'OK, you two!' he said. 'You are under arrest for stealing this diamond!'

While the young police officers arrested the criminals, Frank held the evidence up for everyone to see. In the light from the moon, it shone every colour.

'Wow!' said one of the young police officers. 'I've never seen a real diamond up close.'

'Imagine if someone gave you that as a present!' said the other.

'Just imagine,' Frank agreed. He carefully put it into an evidence bag. Half an hour later, back at the station, he gave it to Spencer. Spencer took it from him carefully, as if it was a new baby.

Five weeks later, Frank was sitting in his new armchair and drinking a glass of the best champagne. His expensive new cat sat at his feet.

He picked up the local newspaper. The two thieves had got six years in prison. The photo in the newspaper was of the Babbingtons. They were standing next to the diamond inside its new, extra-strong glass case. Frank looked closer at the photo of the diamond.

Only an expert would notice anything strange about the Babbington diamond. And only if they saw the diamond up close.

Frank put the newspaper down and picked up one of the travel magazines on his beautiful new coffee table.

'Peggy?' he said. 'Would you like to go to the Bahamas or the Maldives?'

Peggy put down her own champagne glass. A small diamond ring on her finger shone in the light. 'Why not both?' she smiled.

'I did promise you a long cruise,' he said.

'You did!' she replied. 'I'm so glad I called you first when I heard them planning to steal the diamond.'

'Me too, Peggy,' he said. 'Me too.'

Life now he had retired was a wonderful thing after all.

Story written by Clive Lane and adapted by Nicola Prentis

1. Match the following words with their meanings

- | | | |
|---------------------------------|---|---|
| 1. to have a nose for something | - | a. careful not to attract too much attention |
| 2. to frown | - | b. to find someone in the act of doing something illegal |
| 3. to sigh | - | c. an exact copy of an object |
| 4. charm | - | d. to breathe out noisily because you are bored, tired, sad |
| 5. discreet | - | e. to be good at finding a particular thing |
| 6. to catch someone red-handed | - | f. to bring your eyebrows closer together because you are angry, unhappy or thinking hard |
| 7. speeding | - | g. a special quality that someone has that makes you like or feel attracted to them |
| 8. a replica | - | h. driving faster than the legal speed limit |

2. Are the sentences true or false?

1. At the beginning of the story, Frank hoped he might get promoted.
2. Frank guessed that Inspector Spencer would ask for his help.
3. When Spencer told Frank about the plan to steal the diamond, Frank already knew about it.
4. Frank and the other police officers stopped the thieves before they took the diamond.
5. Frank's plan went perfectly.
6. Peggy and Frank shared the rewards of their crime.

3. Write the correct form of the word in brackets.

1. It was Frank's last month in the job and, for him, couldn't come soon enough. (RETIRE)
2. Just as Frank was sighing, Inspector Spencer came up to his desk. (HEAVY)
3. Frank was expecting Spencer to ask him for advice, so he was when Spencer appeared. (SURPRISE)
4. At first, Spencer was with Frank's suggestion. (COMFORT)
5. Both police officers agreed that the arresting officer had to be someone trustworthy and (RELY)
6. 'Is there a problem, officer?' he asked, his face shiny with sweat. (NERVE)
7. While one officer wrote out the speeding ticket, Frank searched the car. (THOROUGH)
8. For Frank, retirement was turning out to be a thing after all. (WONDER)

LISTENING

Listening Exercises

1. Conversations

Exercise 1

Listen to the audio and answer the questions.

1. Write the words and phrases in the correct group.

Right. No way! Let's see ... And? I mean ... Really? Well ... Umm ... I know.

When you're thinking of something to say (4 expressions)	When you show the other person you are listening (5 expressions)

2. Match the topics (1–4) with the conversations (a–d).

Topic	Conversation
1. An old photo	- a. Conversation A
2. A university project	- b. Conversation B
3. A holiday	- c. Conversation C
4. A work interview	- d. Conversation D

3. Are the sentences true or false?

- (Conversation A) The woman was in the interview for 15 minutes.
- (Conversation A) The woman thinks she is going to get the job.
- (Conversation B) The woman was trying to look at art.
- (Conversation B) The woman is thinking about not taking photos on holiday any more.
- (Conversation C) The man and the woman grew up in the same family.
- (Conversation C) The girl had an older boyfriend at school.
- (Conversation D) The man is not in the group because the others don't like his work.
- (Conversation D) The man needs to find another group.

Discussion

Have you ever had a similar conversation? What new phrases did you learn in these conversations?

Exercise 2

Listen to the audio and answer the questions.

1. Complete the phrases with words from the box.

test term links appointment assignment know

1. a doctor's
2. a homework
3. to let someone
4. to post online
5. a practice
6. a mid-..... exam

2. Circle the best answer.

1. Diana can't come to class because ...
 - a. she has a different class.
 - b. she has a mid-term exam.
 - c. she has a doctor's appointment.

2. For homework, she has to read ...
 - a. chapters 17, 18, 19 and 20.
 - b. chapters 17, 19 and 20.
 - c. chapters 17 and 20.

3. The articles and video are available ...
 - a. online.
 - b. via email.
 - c. in the library.

4. The deadline for the homework is ...
 - a. Wednesday.
 - b. Friday.
 - c. Sunday.

5. The teacher can give Diana the practice test ...
 - a. on Friday.

- b. by email.
- c. after the mid-term exam.

6. The office needs ...
- a. a note from the doctor.
 - b. an email from Diana.
 - c. the mid-term exam.

3. Put the words and phrases in order to make sentences.

1. but sorry to class. I I'm can't come
2. can me give the homework you assignment?
3. to chapters 17 read 20. You need to
4. I should do? What
5. links the post I'll online.
6. the practice you give I can test

Discussion

Do you have a lot of homework? What kind of homework do you like?

Exercise 3

Listen to the audio and answer the questions.

1. Match the definitions (a–h) with the vocabulary (1–8).

Vocabulary		Definition
1. an exception	-	a. proof that a delivery has been made
2. payment terms make payment	-	b. the conditions of when a customer should
3. an invoice	-	c. when more time is allowed for something
4. an extension	-	d. an official or organisational rule
5. delivery confirmation- to		e. a document which shows how much a customer has pay, for what and by when
6. cash flow	-	f. when something doesn't follow the usual rule
7. a regulation	-	g. to show someone you are grateful for something they have done
8. to appreciate out	-	h. the timing and amount of money coming in and going of a company

2. Are the sentences true or false?

1. The delivery hasn't arrived yet.
2. Andrea is having cash flow issues and needs a payment extension.
3. Andrea usually asks for an extension of the payment terms.
4. Andrea has a new order to place, even bigger than the last one.

5. Junko can extend the payment terms on the last order to 60 days.

6. Junko will send Andrea an email confirmation.

3. Write the sentences in the correct group.

- *Let me see what I can do.*
- *I promise this won't become the norm.*
- *I'm happy to help you.*
- *I'm not sure if I can do that.*
- *You'll really be helping us.*
- *I appreciate your help.*
- *I need a favour.*
- *I think we can make an exception this time.*

What the customer says	What the supplier says

Discussion

Do you ever do favours or make exceptions for important clients?

Exercise 4

Listen to the audio and answer the questions.

1. Match the definitions (a–f) with the vocabulary (1–6).

Vocabulary

Definition

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. to hand something back | - | a. to hear what someone said |
| 2. to get something
gave it to you | - | b. to give something to the person who |
| 3. to have to do with | - | c. to understand something |
| 4. to catch (what someone said)
student's work to | - | d. to give a number or letter to a
show how good it is |
| 5. to make sense | - | e. to be easy to understand |
| 6. to mark | - | f. to be related or connected to |

2. Are the sentences true or false?

1. The class started five minutes ago.
2. The teacher will hand back the tests next Thursday.
3. The boy shares his textbook with the girl.
4. The teacher is going on about search engines.
5. The boy thought this class was about the French Revolution.
6. The boy is in the wrong class.

3. Put the words in order to make sentences.

1. I missed? what have
2. did the mid-term? he say anything about
3. catch I didn't that
4. meant to be we on? are what page
5. mean? SEO what does
6. with the American Revolution? this what have to do does
7. get don't I it
8. makes now sense. all it

Discussion

When you don't understand something in class, what do you do?

2. Listening to instructions

Exercise 5

Listen to the instructions and draw accordingly in the space provided.

Exercise 6

Listen to the instructions on how to use a coffee maker and write a paragraph based on the instructions.

Exercise 7

Listen to the instructions on how to set up Alexa on an Echo device and write down the instructions in the form of points.

Exercise 8

Listen to a set of general instructions on how to evacuate during an emergency. Write down another list of instructions specifically meant for evacuating people during floods. (You may use the instructions heard on the audio as guidelines)

UNIT V
Grammar in Use

GRAMMAR IN USE

Lesson 1

Talking about the future

Summary

There are three common ways to talk about the future in English.

- With the **'going to' structure**.
*I am really **going to tell** her what I think of her.*
- With the **present progressive**.
*We're **meeting** Malcolm tomorrow.*
- With **will**

The treasurer **will be** in the office from 9.00 till 2.00.

We use **going to** or the **present progressive** especially when the future has some **present reality**: for example to talk about plans that we have already made.

Will can also be used when we **decide, promise or refuse** and in **requests**.

There's the doorbell. **'I'll go'**. Please write every week.' Of course I **will**.

She won't come out of the bathroom. **Will** you get some milk while you're out?

We can sometimes use the **simple present** to talk about the future.

Her plane arrives at 15.30. I'll phone you when I **know** something.

I will see you tomorrow if I **have** a chance.

Exercise 1:

Put the verbs in the right places to complete the sentences. Use 'going to'.

Note: there are too many verbs.

1. Jane is _____ music in Vienna. She's _____ to become a professional pianist. This summer, she's _____ three months studying German. (*spend; try; work; study*)

2. Max is _____ maths and science for his school-leaving exams. Then he's _____ the summer learning to fly. In the autumn, he's _____ a two year training course for airline pilots. (*start; spend; go; do*)

3. Jennifer's eight and she doesn't know what she's _____. One day she says she's _____ a dancer, and next she says she's _____ with animals. This summer, she's _____ with her aunt in America. (*take; work; do; stay; be*)

4. Annie is _____ the house this summer. Then she's _____ two weeks walking in Scotland. In the autumn, she's _____ a new job as a translator. (*start; decorate; spend; play*)

Exercise 2:

Write some sentences about your plans for the coming week

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Exercise 3:

Complete the sentences with verbs from the box. Use 'will' or 'won't'.

answer	call	come	drive	eat	go	send	tell	tell	wash	write
--------	------	------	-------	-----	----	------	------	------	------	-------

1. I the cups. You can dry them.
2. I am tired. I think I to bed now.
3. Sheus what's wrong.
4. The cat I think it's ill.
5. The phone's ringing. Iit.
6. Iyou the date when I know myself.
7. I promise Ito you every week.
8. That child out of the classroom.
9. If you don't get out of here, Ithe police.
10. Iyou all the papers on Friday.

Lesson 2

Modal Verbs

Summary

MODAL VERBS: can, could may, might shall, should will, would must ought to
--

The **modal verbs** are a special group of auxiliary verbs. We use them **before other verbs** to express certain meanings – for example, **permission, ability, possibility, certainty**.

Modals have **different grammar** from other verbs. For example, they have no –s on the third person singular; we say **he can, NOT he cans**.

Have to, be able to, used to, had better, be supposed to and **needn't** are similar to modals in some ways.

Exercise 1:

Complete the sentences using expressions from the box (once or more than once).

be able to	to be able to	been able to	been allowed to	have to	to have to	had to
------------	---------------	--------------	-----------------	---------	------------	--------

1. One day, everybody willtravel where they want.
2. I'm afraid you will.....work next weekend.
3. I would hatelive in a big city.
4. I would have enjoyed the holiday more if I hadspeak Spanish.
5. I'd likeski better.
6. She's neverspell properly.
7. I hateget up early.
8. We'vemove house twice this year.
9. I've neverdrive my father's car.
10. Will youcome fishing next Saturday?

Exercise 2:

Choose the best word(s):

1.you swim? (may, can, shall)
2. I really go now. (shall, would, must)
3. Wesee Ann tomorrow. (might, ought, would)
4. Youto see the doctor. (should, could, ought)
5. Iunderstand him. (couldn't, mustn't, be able)
6. Yoube here at exactly 10.00. Don't be late. (must, may, might)
7.I carry your bag? (might, will, can)
8. Itrain tomorrow. (may, would, shall)
9. Itbe 10 o'clock already! (might not, can't, oughtn't to)
10. Yoube very tired after your journey. (would, must, can)

Exercise 3:**Complete the sentences, using must not/mustn't/do not/don't have to**

1. Campersplay music after 10 p.m.
2. Studentsask permission to stay out after midnight.
3. Bicyclesbe parked in the front courtyard.
4. Residentshang washing out of the windows.
5. Passengerslean out of the window.
6. Youpay for your tickets now.
7. Youdisturb your sister while she's working.
8. Weleave the windows open or the rain will come in.
9. Wehurry. There's plenty of time.
10. Iforget to send Peter a birthday card.

Lesson 3

Infinitives

Summary

Infinitives often have to before them; but not always.

I want **to go** home, but I can't **go** now.

Negative infinitives are made with **not (to)**.

I told her **not to pay**.

Besides ordinary infinitives, there are also **progressive**, **perfect** and **passive** infinitives.

I'd like **to be lying** on the beach now.

You ought **to have told** me.

He can **be found** in the cafe most afternoons.

We can use **infinitives** to say **why** we do things.

I got up early **to say** goodbye to Miriam.

We often use **-ing** forms as **subjects**.

Smoking is dangerous. (More natural than *To smoke is dangerous*.)

If we use **infinitives** as **subjects**, we prefer a structure with **it**.

It's dangerous **to smoke**.

We can use infinitives after some adjectives and nouns.

I'm glad **to be** here.

I've got work **to do**.

After prepositions we use **-ing** forms, not infinitives

You can't live without eating. (NOT...~~without to eat~~)

Exercise 1

Change the sentences, using prepositions and -ing forms:

1. I am thinking that I might go to Australia. (thinking of)

2. Working with children interests me. (interested in)

3. I listen to her all day and I'm tired of it. (tired of)

4. She paints well. (good at)

5. I'm not a good listener. (bad at)

6. It was very kind of you to help me. (Thank you for)

7. I stayed in bed. I didn't go to work. (instead of)

8. You can't live if you don't eat. (without)
9. We said we might have a party. (talk about)
10. He passed the exam although he did no work. (in spite of)

Exercise 2

Put in the right kind of infinitive:

1. I oughtright now. (work)
2. Your watch willby Tuesday. (repair)
3. I'd likehome early today. (go)
4. I'd likeher face when she opened the letter.
(see)
5. She musta shower – I can hear the water
running. (have)
6. It's importantto people. (listen)
7. She hopesfor the national team. (choose)
8. Tryback late. (not be)
9. You shouldme you were ill. (tell)
10. He doesn't likewhile he's working.
(interrupt)

Exercise 3

Write some sentences about yourself using prepositions and –ing forms

1. I'm thinking of
2. I've often thought of
3. I've never thought of
4. I'm quite good at
5. I'm not very good at
6. I'm bad at
7. I'm interested in
8. I'm not interested in
9. I couldn't live without
10. I could easily live without

Lesson 4

Determiners

Summary

this, that, these, those	some, any, no	all, each, every	both, either, neither
much, many, a little, a few	enough	too much/many	less, least
a lot, lots	which, what	(articles a/an, possessives my, your etc.)	

Determiners are words that come at the beginning of noun phrases, before adjectives. Determiners help to show **which** or **how much/many** we are talking about.

This small dog **some** new suggestions **all** Scottish towns **enough** time

Exercise 1

Complete the sentence using, any, somebody, anybody, something or anything.

1. I can't find butter, but we've got margarine.
2. Did you meet interesting at the party?
3. Emma has got old pictures of the house.
4. Can I offer you wine?
5. Do you know German?
6. Helen brought me beautiful roses.
7. Is there I can do?
8. There's waiting to see you.
9. I haven't got to wear.
10. Shall we listen to music?

Exercise 2

Join the beginnings and ends.

0. 'What are those?'	A 'Chocolates.' 0
1. 'What did she give you?'	B any money with you?
2. Cheese is made from	C some milk in my coffee?
3. Could I have	D 'Some chocolates.'
4. Why does she always talk about	E milk.
5. Have you got	F money?
6. Her children are both	G air.
7. In the pub we met	H students.

8. Let me show you	I good photos.
9. Open the window and let in	J some fresh air.
10. This camera takes	K some photos of the children.
11. You can't live without	L some students.

Exercise 3

Complete each sentence with 'any' and a word from the box.

Bank	boy	bus	problems	colour	day	doctor	question	supermarket
------	-----	-----	----------	--------	-----	--------	----------	-------------

1. He gets angry with who talks to his girlfriend.
2. 'Would you like red, blue...?' 'It doesn't matter. is OK.'
3. You can get this kind of rice in
4. I think she knows everything. She can answer you ask.
5. If you have, come and ask me for help.
6. 'When shall we meet?' 'I don't mind. this week.'
7. 'Where can I change money?' 'In
8. You can't take just

Source:

Oxford English Grammar Course – Intermediate : Michael Swan and Catherine Walter.
OUP, 2019

ERROR CORRECTION

Exercise 1

1. I will seeing you tomorrow.
2. Tomorrow will be warm and sunny.
3. I promise I pay you tomorrow.
4. The President arrives in London on Monday.
5. I going to get up early tomorrow
6. 'I have lost my keys.' 'I find them for you'.
7. I think it's raining this evening.
8. Look out! You fall!
9. Are you going to write to Patrick?
10. Who's cooking this evening?

Exercise 2

1. When will school start?
2. We go to Spain sometime soon.
3. I stop smoking after Christmas.
4. The exams will be in June.
5. I am having a lecture at 9.00 tomorrow.
6. The train won't stop at Oxford.
7. I come round after 7.00.
8. I play football tomorrow.
9. What time will the concert end?
10. I post your letters.

Exercise 3

1. I don't can sing.
2. I would like to can travel more.
3. He should to work harder.
4. Could you telling me the time?
5. I must work last Saturday and Sunday.
6. One day everybody will can have enough to eat.
7. In this country, boys must not do military service.
8. That mustn't be Angela. She is in America.
9. You ought phone your sister.
10. I ran for the bus, and I could catch it.

Exercise 4

1. I have phoned you, but didn't have your number.
2. I couldn't have put so much garlic in the soup.
3. If you needed money, you must have asked me.
4. He couldn't have bought eggs. We have got plenty.

5. She never got my letter. I may have addressed it properly.
6. I think you must have a cup of tea.
7. I can see you at 8 in the morning.
8. It took a long time, but I manages to repair the car.
9. I can ask you to help me tomorrow.
10. They are not at home. They should have gone away for the weekend.

Exercise 5

Correct the mistakes or write 'Correct'.

1. I'd like know where she buys her clothes.....
2. He seems be ill.
3. I promise to send you photos of the baby.....
4. Try not to be late
5. They will probably be back home in August.....
6. You mustn't to expect too much.....
7. It's important to learn to relax.....
8. I want get a new bike.....
9. You had better to think again.....
10. John may phone this afternoon.....

Exercise 6

Correct the mistakes or write 'Correct'

1. I always have a cup of tea before I go to bed.
2. Please remember buying milk.
3. She learnt English mostly by talk to people.
4. I want everybody is here tomorrow.
5. I'll never forget to meeting you.
6. What would you like to do now?
7. I'm sorry to be woken you up.
8. It's important to tell everybody.
9. Please tell that man to stop to scream.
10. We visited Cambridge and then went on seeing Oxford.

Exercise 7

Correct the mistakes or write 'Correct'

1. Not anybody wrote to me last week.
2. None her friends helped her.
3. She talks so fast that anybody can understand her.
4. I have much free time.
5. You're walking too much slowly. We'll be late.
6. Have we got enough of chairs for everybody?
7. This soup isn't enough warm.
8. 'Did you find any mushrooms?' 'Yes, a lot of.'
9. We found the place without no difficulty.
10. We'll be here for another six days.

Exercise 8**Correct the mistakes or write 'Correct'**

1. Who's this man over there talking to Anna?
2. I've hardly got no time these days.
3. Mark and Joanna are here, but where are the others?
4. We all will be on holiday next week.
5. Not every birds can fly.
6. Not all birds can fly.
7. What leg hurts the left or the right?
8. Sally got a lot presents for her birthday.
9. She gave me a lot of information, but I don't remember all.
10. You can have either room - they're both free.

Source:

**Oxford English Grammar Course – Intermediate : Michael Swan and Catherine Walter.
OUP, 2019**

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPERS

English II

Sample Question Paper

End Semester Examination (ESE)

Time : 3 hours

Marks : 100

Section A

Answer all the questions

2x 10 = 20

1. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.

- a. I stop smoking after Christmas.
- b. I think it's raining this evening.

2. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.

- a. I must work last Saturday and Sunday.
- b. I can ask you to help me tomorrow.

3. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.

- a. You mustn't to expect too much.
- b. I have much free time.

4. Complete the sentence using, any, somebody, anybody, something or anything.

- a. I can't find butter, but we've got margarine.
- b. Did you meet interesting at the party?

5. Put in the right kind of infinitive:

- a. It's importantto people. (listen)
- b. She hopesfor the national team.
(choose)

6. Complete the following sentences with the correct tense of the verbs given in brackets

- a. Wesee Ann tomorrow. (might, ought, would)
- b. Youto see the doctor. (should, could, ought)

7. Give the synonyms of :

- a. vernacular
- b. rattled

8. Give one-word substitute:

- a. the process of making a garden or other piece of land more attractive
- b. a party or ceremony celebrating a move to a new home

9. Use the word *empower* in a meaningful sentence.

10. Match the following words with their meanings.

S.No.	Words	Meaning
1.	paradox	principal character in a literary work
2.	plot	a joke based on the interplay of homophones — words with the same pronunciation but different meanings.
3.	eponym	a direct and vivid comparison between two things usually considered distinct or unrelated
4.	protagonist	the sequence of events that make up a story
		refers to a person or thing after which something else is named

Section B**Answer all the questions in about 150 words****5 x 7 = 35**

11. Read the following passage and answer the questions given.

Orangutan means “person of the forest” in the Malay language. Orangutans are great apes. They belong to the family of primates that includes gorillas, chimpanzees, and bonobos.

Wild orangutans live on two islands-Sumatra and Borneo-in Southeast Asia. Both Sumatran orangutans and Bornean orangutans are primarily arboreal. This means they spend most of their time in trees. Orangutans have long and powerful arms. Their arms help them climb and swing between trees in the rainforest. They also have long fingers and toes that help them grasp tree branches.

Orangutans are frugivores. This means that they mostly eat fruit. They also eat leaves, flowers, and sometimes insects. Over 300 different types of food have been found in their diet. Orangutans play a very important role in spreading fruit and plant seeds in the forest. This helps to keep their rainforest home healthy.

There are many ways orangutans show that they are smart and intelligent. They create and use tools to remove seeds from fruit. They also use tools to capture insects from the insides of trees. Orangutans memorize the rainforest where they live. This helps them know which trees have ripe fruit. They build a sleeping nest each night made of branches and leaves.

Male orangutans live alone. Female orangutans live with their babies or with young orangutans. Orangutans can live to be over 50 years old.

Bornean and Sumatran orangutans are critically endangered species. This means they are at a very high risk of disappearing forever. Scientists estimate that there are less than 55,000 Bornean orangutans remaining in the wild. They believe there are less than 7,000 Sumatran orangutans left in the rainforests. Orangutans face many threats due to human activity. Young orangutans are sometimes captured and sold as pets. Orangutans are also hunted for food.

The biggest threat facing orangutans is the destruction of their rainforest home. Scientists estimate that 80% of their forest home has been lost in the last 20 years. Rainforests in Borneo and Sumatra are being destroyed to create palm oil plantations. Millions of acres of forest are cut down and burned each year. Palm oil is the most widely produced edible vegetable oil. Palm oil can be found in candy bars, cookies, and crackers. It is also used to make shampoos,

soaps, and pet food. Most of the palm oil produced in the world is grown in Borneo and Sumatra. Wildlife organizations are working hard to help protect the remaining rainforests. If the rainforests disappear, orangutans will disappear forever.

Questions

1. How do orangutans assist in preserving the rainforests?
2. Where are wild orangutans found?
3. What does the word, 'orangutan' mean?
4. Explain the term, 'arboreal' in connection with the traits of the orangutan.
5. What impact does creation of palm oil plantations have on the orangutans?
6. Why are Bornean and Sumatran orangutans 'critically endangered'?
7. We walked down the valley through _____ so thick with plants that light barely pierced through.
a. mountain b. river c. rainforests d. plains

12. You are on a holiday with family in a hill station. Write a postcard to your friend detailing a few highlights of your trip.

13. a. Explain why Judith Candiru and Emmanuel Cosmos Msoka deserve to be called 'pandemic heroes'.

OR

b. Compare and contrast between Billy Collins' experiences as a tourist in Italy and when he is in the familiar surroundings of his home in America.

14. a. Construct a paragraph on how the health ministry of Kerala dealt with the Covid crisis.

OR

b. Why did the author conclude that the translations of Bharathi's poems into English 'simply refuses to work'?

15. a. As depicted in "Returns", identify the reasons why the foreigners who arrived at Kabul stayed there only for a short period of time?

OR

b. Summarise the events that happened in the immediate aftermath of the first lockdown in India as presented by Alia Allana in her essay, "India's comfort food tells the story of its pandemic".

Section C

Answer the following in about 250 words.

16. Read the following story and answer the questions.

The green wars

Plan 1: Guerrilla gardening

The time is what the military call 'oh-three-hundred-hours' – three o'clock in the morning. We're in the car park of the sports centre. It's totally empty except for me, my best friend, Janey and an old truck that belongs to the company that put grass on the town football pitch last week. 'What are we doing here?' I ask. 'Here's the plan,' says Janey. 'First, we borrow that truck ...'

‘I’m going home,’ I say. ‘Good night.’ ‘Then, we drive to the Town Hall. And then we use the grass in the truck to cover the high street from top to bottom, like one great big garden. Ready?’

I think about it for a minute. Then I smile. ‘OK,’ I say. ‘Let’s go.’ ...

Our new green high street is beautiful. But we don’t have long to admire it. The judge says we’re guilty of a crime. Several crimes in fact, including theft, vandalism and disturbing the peace. I get sentenced to 150 hours of community service and Janey gets 300 hours because it was her idea.

I stay out of trouble, do 150 hours cleaning graffiti and get back to my studies. Janey is planning how we’re going to do our guerrilla gardening better in future. Our mission is to make the whole town green again. Janey’s ideas will probably put us both in prison eventually. But someone needs to take urgent action to help the planet.

Plan 2: The bamboo forest

Every September, our town has a festival. There’s a big parade through the city, with crowds of happy people eating junk food and waving little flags. Then everyone goes to the park on the edge of town, where the mayor gives a speech and everyone has fun. I’m supposed to be packing my bags to go and study engineering at university, but as soon as everyone has gone to the park, Janey picks me up in another ‘borrowed’ truck. This one is loaded with soil and, judging by the smell, manure. ‘Get in,’ she says. ‘There’s enough soil here to cover the high street from Baker’s Lane to Humber Road, right past the new shopping centre.’ When Janey gets an idea, she doesn’t let it go easily. ‘You’re crazy,’ I tell her. ‘Crazy genius,’ she says. ‘I’ve mixed soil, manure and the fastest-growing variety of bamboo seeds you can order online. By the time the festival is over, there’ll be a mini forest blocking the road to the supermarket. It really does grow that fast. What do you think?’ Well ... why not? I’ll be at university next week anyway. ‘Let’s do it.’ ... Janey was right, bamboo does grow fast. It was knee-high before anyone discovered what we had done. By the time the council found someone to come and cut it down, our bamboo forest had grown taller than the mayor. It was great, but they took it away. After what we did last year, no one had any doubt about who was responsible. Janey had taken the truck back, but the police traced the seed purchase to her bank account. This time she got six months in prison. She didn’t tell them I’d helped her, so I still went to university. By the time she got out, I’d changed my degree to Agriculture and Wildlife. I figured I should really devote some time to learning about gardening and stuff if Janey and I were going to succeed.

Questions

1. What is the gist of the plan 1, Guerrilla Gardening? (2)
2. What did the author and her friend propose to do as part of the ‘Bamboo Forest’ plan? (2)
3. State whether the following statements are true or false. (4)
 - a. Plan 1 was Janey’s idea.
 - b. The truck they use belongs to the narrator.
 - c. When Janey goes to prison for the first time, the narrator goes to university.
 - d. When the city council found someone to cut the bamboo forest, the shoots had grown taller than an average man.

4. Arrange the following sentences in the right order. (2)

- a. As soon as everyone has gone to the park, Janey picks me up in another 'borrowed' truck, loaded with soil and manure.
- b. There's a big parade through the city, with crowds of happy people eating junk food and waving little flags.
- c. Janey and I covered the high street from Baker's Lane to Humber Road, right past the new shopping centre with the soil.
- d. Then everyone goes to the park on the edge of town, where the mayor gives a speech and everyone has fun

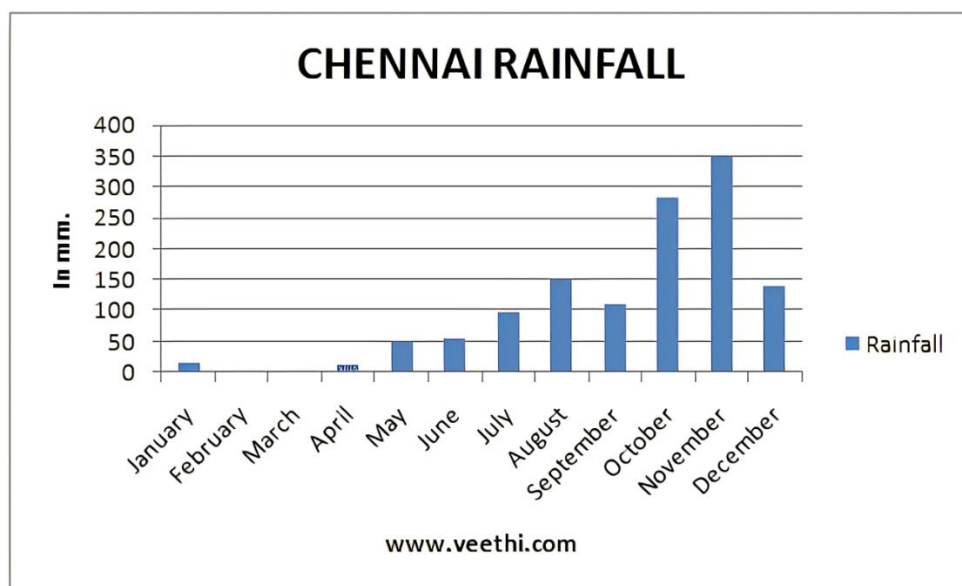
5. Match the words/ terms with their meanings. (3)

S.No.	Words	Meanings
1.	Guerrilla gardening	a person who is elected to be the leader of a town or city
2.	Council	growing plants without permission on someone else's land or in a public space
3.	Community service	a group of people who form the government of a town
		work that someone has to do because they committed a crime

6. Complete the sentences with the correct option. (2)

- a. The old buildings were thickly covered with colourful _____ which took volunteers weeks to clean up. (plants/grease/graffiti/moss)
- b. Janey's _____ in life was to protect the environment. (mission/precursor/ambit/perspective)

17. a. Write a brief report based on the graph presented below. (5)



b. Write a bio-sketch of your favourite sportsperson. (10).

18. a. From your reading of the essay, “On searching for a once-lost love”, examine how the author’s love for travel propelled him to experience the various facets of life in a country as diverse as India?

OR

b. Chris Gardner’s professional success is a story of the triumph of the human spirit. Analyse this statement and give your response with reference to the film, *The Pursuit of Happyness*.

Sample Question Paper

English I

Continuous Internal Assessment Test (CIA)

Time : 90 minutes

Marks : 50

SECTION A

Answer all the questions (10 marks)

I. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences. (4)

1. He gets angry with somebody who talks to his girlfriend.
2. Is there any I can do?
3. I am thinking that I might go to New York.
4. I'd like see her face when she opens the gift.

II. Fill in the blanks with the correct verbs in the future tense. (4)

5. I _____ go to the beach.
6. My friends _____ join my baseball team.
7. I'm _____ to phone Mum after dinner. I told her I'd call at 8 o'clock.
8. I'm _____ to wear my black dress tonight.

3. Make sentences with the following words: (2)

9. pursuit
10. banter

SECTION B

I. Answer the following questions in about 100 words: 4 x 5 = 20 marks

11..Read the following passage and answer the questions given below:

The soft glow from the digital display flickered as the minutes sluggishly passed. The pale green cast an eerie shadow across my bed, while outside was as dark as a raven's pupil. The streetlight outside of the window had blown its bulb and towered, redundantly, over the pavement. Nothing moved, apart from me, anxiously turning and fidgeting my blankets into a tangle. I heard a faint hum from downstairs; the sound of the dishwasher automatically starting, churning and rumbling the plates from dinner until they sparkled. My mind churned like the machine, impossible to turn off now it had started. I checked the clock again. The night felt endless.

I shuffled over to turn on the light. Silhouetted against the inside of a shade, a fly lazily crept to the top, balancing on the rim like a tiny tightrope walker. I watched as it fluttered its wings slightly, before it took off in a frenzy of buzzing around the top of my bed, going nowhere in particular. I wondered what its purpose was. Why was it here? It hummed close to my face and

I swatted it away gruffly. It landed back on the rim, satisfied with its little flurry of activity, as I reached over to turn off the light again.

The clock's mechanical glow informed me that only a few minutes had passed. I sighed and attempted to still my mind. I had numbers, facts and figures spiralling down a rabbit hole in my mind, becoming jumbled and muddled. I could see the dim outlines of my post it notes, meticulously written and ordered; with all of the information I could ever need neatly written in my careful handwriting. But now all of that order had turned to chaos, as I struggled to remember even the simplest of equations. I needed to get some sleep, but my brain point-blank refused to let me.

Outside, I heard the sudden honking of a horn and a dog's incessant barking. Voices muffled by wall and curtain were just about audible, sounding like they were being spoken through a thick soup of fog. A car door slammed; the dog's barking became increasingly urgent. Voices raised again, before another slam and the roar of an engine increased and then faded out as the car disappeared down the street. The dog stopped barking and all was still once again. I stared at my curtains, considering whether to go downstairs to make myself a drink.

1. Which of the following statement is right based on your reading of the passage?
 - a. The narrator moved a little.
 - b. The narrator hardly moved.
 - c. The narrator moved considerably.
 - d. None of the above.
2. The narrator makes a reference to a tight rope walker. What is the context?
3. Give the meanings of the following words: *incessant*, *muffled*, *spiralling*, *slammed*
4. State whether the following sentences are *Correct* or *Incorrect*.
 - a. The narrator's meticulous notes turned into chaos.
 - b. Numbers, facts and figures did not jumble in the narrator's head.
 - c. Narrator's post it notes were written neatly and carefully.
 - d. Narrator could distinctly remember simple equations.

5. Describe the dishwasher in motion.

12. You are currently holidaying in Ladakh, the Himalayan region with a group of friends. Write a postcard to your family about the spectacular sights of the mountains.

13 a. How does A R Venkatachalapathy the historian compare and contrast the personalities of Subramania Bharathi and Tagore?

(OR)

13 b. How does Billy Collins express his relief when his vacation plans to Italy gets cancelled?

14 a. Build a paragraph on Kunwar's role in community outreach as documented by UNICEF during the Covid-crisis years.

(OR)

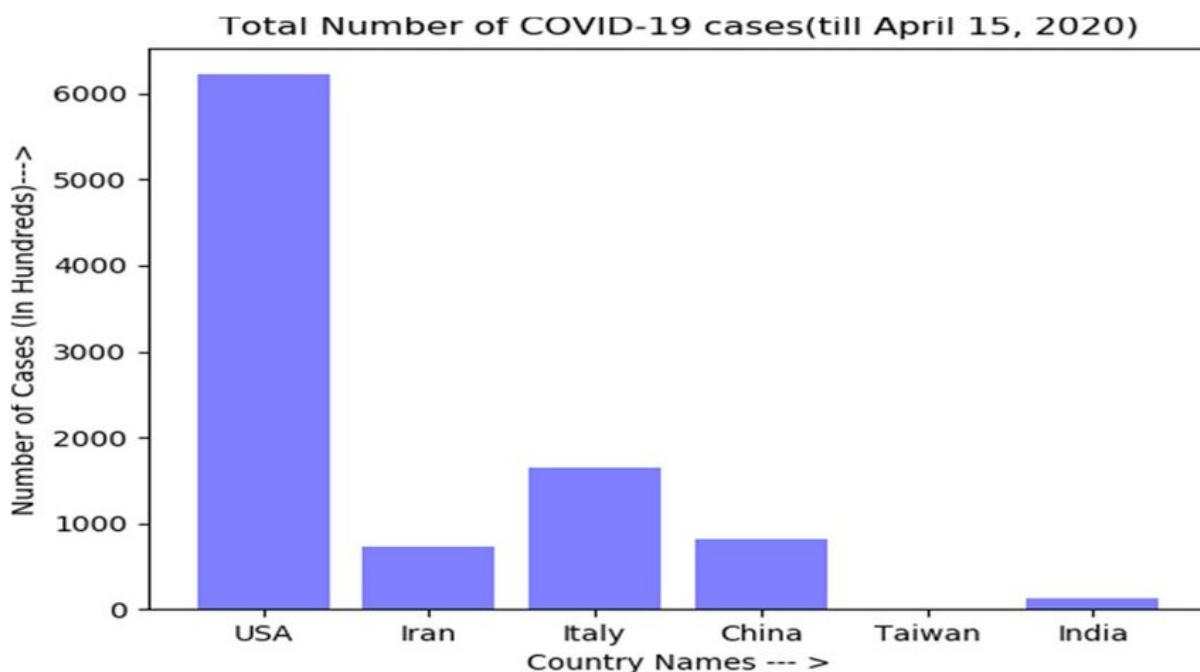
14 b. Construct a short note on how Samanth Subramaniam went searching for the best sea food in the coastal town of Mangalore.

SECTION C

Answer the following question

(2 x 10 = 20 marks)

15. Write a report based on the bar graph given below:



Bar graph representing the total number of cases in different countries. (The USA: 622412, Iran: 76389, Italy: 165155, China: 82160, Taiwan: 12320, India: 12320)

16 a. Examine the pioneering efforts and strategies of former Health Minister KK Shailaja in containing Corona virus in Kerala as presented in “A Deadlier Virus Strikes”.

(OR)

16 b. The film *Pursuit of Happyness* is a typical rags-to-riches story, chronicling the hardships and struggles of Chris Gardner on his path to success. Discuss.

Internal Evaluation (break-up)

CIA Test 1 + CIA Test 2 - 30 marks

Generic Skills (Speaking &

Listening) - 15 marks

Attendance - 5 marks

Total - 50 marks